Issue 6: On Sedition

By Hannah Lim
Summer 2026, NYC

Colloquially, sedition is defined as language intended to incite insurrection against the governing authority, but regarding the legal definition, Edward Jenks writes in *The Book of English Law* that sedition is "perhaps the very vaguest of all offences." The legal application of sedition as a criminal charge thus creates a self-aware dialogue around the morals and functions of the ambient governing bias of its time and place. In light of a few major sedition prosecutions in the United States in the last five years, this zine examines the surreality and unreality of life for a young woman in the modern American Republic through my own personal descent into madness this summer.

Today, the federal government criminalizes seditious conspiracy in 18 U.S.C. 2384, which states, "[i]f two or more persons in [the U.S.], conspire to overthrow, put down, or to destroy by force the Government of the United States, or to levy war against them, or to oppose by force the authority thereof, or by force to prevent, hinder, or delay the execution of any law of the United States, or by force to seize, take, or possess any property of the United States contrary to the authority thereof, they shall each be fined under this title or imprisoned not more than twenty years, or both."

The minimum standard categorizing a conspiracy as "seditious" is not defined, except by the word "force," which begs: What is force? In her critical analysis of the Iliad, Simone Veil defines force as "that x that turns anybody who is subjected to it into a thing. Exercised to the limit, it turns man into a thing in the most literal sense: it makes a corpse out of him. Somebody was here, and the next minute there is nobody here at all."

Force therefore, is that which is capable of stripping the human of her humanity. When such force exists, and indeed is wielded by every person alive, how do we contend with the fragile value of human life, freedom, and dignity? How do we control such forces in human aggregate projects called governments or markets? When our systems of governance have clearly shown themselves capable of such force (force which unmoors the soul from the body), even basic measures of self-defense, self-respect, and self-dignity fall well into the definition of sedition. What, then, is implied by its criminality? These questions are sadly not answered by this volume of my zine, but if anyone knows the answers please let me know.

Beginning of the Surreal Descent

In June, a dear friend and writing partner of mine, Tomás, died suddenly from a congenital health condition. No one I loved had ever died before, and the pain from this was a strong enough catalyst to break me like a twix. The following period of my surreal, psychic distress and departure from reality co-existed the 2026 FIFA world cup finals games in NYC *and* the prisoners' hunger strike at Delaney Hall ICE detention center just 11 miles away in New Jersey, which is a very unique experience I can only describe as k-holing at the evil circus. Though to be fair I had been spiraling for months already and I think my mad descent really began in January.

At that time, I had been working as a software engineer for five years in Microsoft's cloud service, Azure. I worked on a core algorithmic component which allocated datacenter resources for customers' requested virtual machines; This sentence is so distilled of major complexity, that it is almost a lie, but since I didn't read my NDA very carefully, I will leave it at that.

One fateful weekend in January, I went to a deportation defense rapid response training where I learned how to respond to an ICE sighting in New York City. We split up and sat according to our boroughs of residence, and listened to a 3 hour power-point presentation from two activists using aliased names Salt and Pepper (which have been changed for anonymity, but imagine something equally as cute). We reviewed publicly published photos of detainment in action to practice visually distinguishing the ICE agents (to avoid mixing them up with the NYPD, the National Guard, and other non-ICE law enforcement actors). They don't seem to have any uniform requirements. Many of the agents wore plain clothes with lazy and potent outlines of their guns and vests underneath. Most did not have badges or other visible markers of identification. Many bore the military build marked by broad shoulders, stout torso, and tense posture – a body, decidedly masculine, constructed as an interchangeable and anonymous tool and weapon of the state. All of the agents wore face masks. We saw one agent wearing a black mask emblazoned with the Nazi Totenkopf skull. In all the images, the detainees faces were blurred.

Because ICE agents are famously unvetted, untrained, and trigger-happy, and their violation of, and disregard for civilian rights is so ubiquitous, we were encouraged during rapid response to take videos of the detainment in action for later use in filing post-detainment habeas corpus petitions (judicial orders requesting law enforcement authorities to produce a prisoner they are holding, and to justify the prisoner's continued confinement). ICE officers are so unfamiliar with the law, in fact, that I originally wrote the bulk of this section using the word "detainment" and I had to edit most of those usages out in post where they read like full-blooded satire. It is also a well-documented fact that people "detained" by ICE disappear in the system, and though many ICE detainments are single collections targeting specific people who are asked or

tricked to produce proof of their identity, an ICE agent does not *need* a warrant to perform an arrest, and many detainments are only legally justified ad-hoc by a very loose set of standards including country of origin, language, or occupation, to produce "reasonable suspicion" that someone is an illegal immigrant.

This was not always the case, but in September of 2025, the U.S. Supreme Court, in a 6-3 decision on *Noem v. Vasquez-Perdomo*, lifted a lower court ban on ICE's "roving patrols" in Los Angeles. The ACLU of Wisconsin elaborated: "What does that mean in plain language? This means that ICE agents now have the legal cover to stop, question, and detain people based on appearance, language, accent, workplace, or any other marker that "looks suspicious" to them. In other words, the Court just gave its blessing to racial profiling on a massive scale—and they did it without a full briefing or hearing and without explaining their reasoning."

Even though we did not actually learn or do anything illegal at the training (in fact mostly, we learned a lot about what exactly IS legal, and talked at length about curtilage trespassing law), I felt as if I was at huge risk at that time, knowing all of our phones were broadcasting our locations, and considering that the administration seemed only passively interested in legality as a structure capable of enabling the terms of its own brutality and agenda. Research shows that personalized paranoia is one of the two most common schizophrenic conspiracies (grandeur being the other), but having anxious delusions of persecution in a burgeoning fascist regime is like being a hypochondriac during COVID.

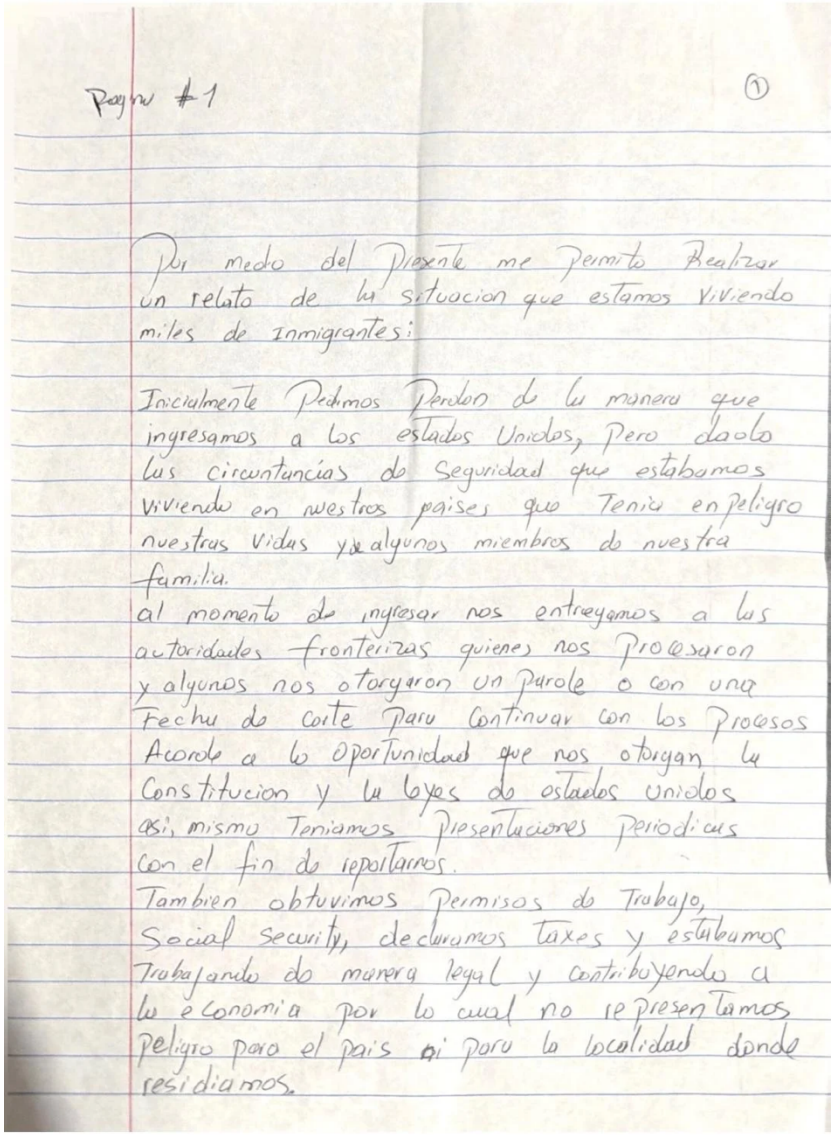
I brought a notebook and a pen, and six of my friends. We talked through grassroots resistance strategies such as yelling, using a whistle, passively forming crowds around vehicles, public shaming, informing detainees of their rights, and we were instructed to remember, above all, that the person being kidnapped is being kidnapped. We studied a photo of one woman with her hands held behind her back, pressed against a car by a man in a black mask and sunglasses. Both people in the photo were visually beheaded: faces covered, pixelated, masked, or abstracted. The man wore jeans and a tactical vest. The photo showed her bent at an angle, her body, modified by an acute and multi-dimensional violence. I had assumed her face was blurred for privacy, but did not consider that it might be blurred as gore. "Is this ICE?" we were asked. We were not sure.

After the training the six of us went to a nearby bar where I tried not to cry. At the time, I was mainly confused at the idea that I was the one who would have to stop someone from getting kidnapped. I'm 5'2".

After this, a group emergent from my local mutual aid network began morning and evening walks to protect our own neighborhoods from the kidnappings, and to identify large staging areas for raids where caravans of unmarked rental vans could theoretically gather to strategize a mass abduction. In the mornings, I would walk loops or grids around my neighborhood, and then around 8 AM, I would sit down at my desk to answer emails for the very same empire.

El Grito de Nosotros

By Leonardo Villalba, and 25 additional signatories
February 2026, Smuggled out of Delaney Hall ICE Detention Center, New Jersey



Pagina #1 ①

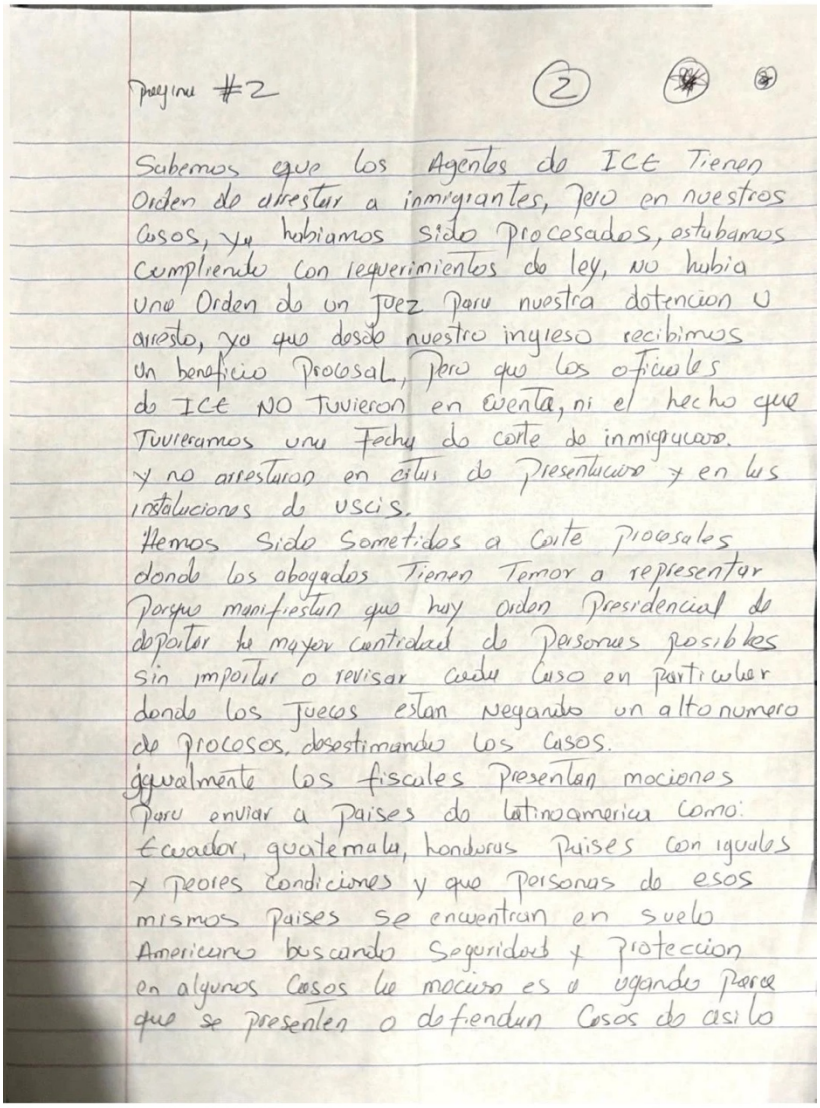
Por medio del Presente me Permito Realizar un relato de la situacion que estamos viviendo miles de Inmigrantes:

Inicialmente Pedimos Perdon de la manera que ingresamos a los estados Unidos, Pero dadas las circuntancias de Seguridad que estabamos viviendo en nuestros paises que Tenia en peligro nuestras Vidas y algunos miembros de nuestra familia.
al momento de ingresar nos entregamos a las autoridades fronterizas quienes nos Procesaron y algunos nos otorgaron un Parole o con una Fecha de Corte Para Continuar con los Procesos Acorde a la oportunidad que nos otorgan la Constitucion y la leyes de estados Unidos Asi, mismo Teniamos Presentaciones periodicas con el fin de reportarnos.
Tambien obtuvimos Permisos de Trabajo, Social security, declaramos taxes y estabamos Trabajando de manera legal y contribuyendo a la economia por lo cual no representamos Peligro para el pais ni para la localidad donde residiamos.

Through this letter, I would like to describe the situation that thousands of immigrants are currently living through:

First, we'd like to apologize for the way we entered the United States, but we were experiencing safety circumstances that endangered our lives and the lives of some members of our family.

Upon entering, we surrendered ourselves to border authorities who processed us. Some of us were given parole or a court date to continue our cases in accordance with the due process afforded to us by the Constitution and laws of the United States. We also attended periodic check-ins, obtained work permits and social security numbers, filed taxes, and were working legally and contributing to the economy. Therefore, we did not pose a threat to the country or the communities where we resided.



Pagina #2 (2)

Sabemos que los Agentes de ICE Tienen Orden de arrestar a inmigrantes, pero en nuestros Casos, ya habiamos sido procesados, estabamos Cumpliendo con requerimientos de ley, no habia Una Orden de un Juez para nuestra detencion o arresto, ya que desde nuestro ingreso recibimos Un beneficio Procesal, pero que los oficiales de ICE NO Tuvieron en cuenta, ni el hecho que Tuvieramos una Fecha de corte de inmigracion. y no arrestaron en citas de Presentacion y en las instalaciones de USCIS.

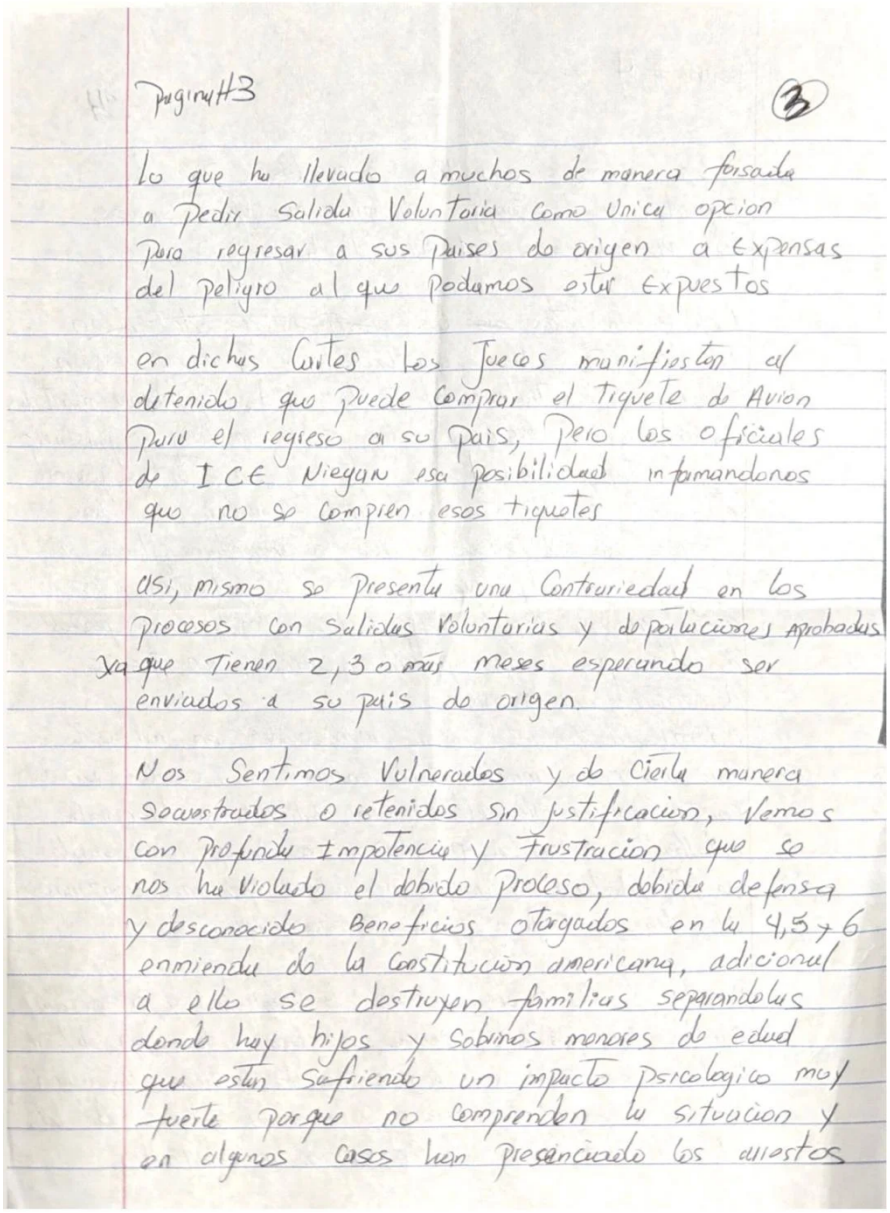
Hemos Sido Sometidos a Corte Procesales donde los abogados Tienen Temor a representar Porque manifiestan que hay Orden Presidencial de deportar la mayor cantidad de Personas posibles sin importar o revisar Cada Caso en particular donde los Jueces estan Negando un alto numero de procesos, desestimando los Casos.

igualmente los fiscales Presentan mociones para enviar a Paises de latinoamerica Como: Ecuador, guatemala, honduras Paises con iguales y Peores Condiciones y que Personas de esos mismos Paises se encuentran en suelo Americano buscando Seguridad y Proteccion en algunos Casos la mocion es de ugando para que se presenten o defiendan Casos de asilo

We know that ICE agents have orders to arrest immigrants. In our cases, we had already been processed and were complying with legal requirements. There was no judge's order for our detention or arrest, since we received a procedural benefit upon our entry, but the ICE officers did not take this into account, nor the fact that we had an immigration court date. They arrested us at scheduled appointments and at USCIS offices.

We have been subjected to court proceedings where lawyers are afraid to represent us because they say there is a presidential order to deport as many people as possible without considering or reviewing each case individually. Judges are denying a large number of cases, dismissing them outright.

Simultaneously, prosecutors are filing motions to send us to Latin American countries like Ecuador, Guatemala, and Honduras, countries with similar or worse conditions. Even people from those same countries are seeking safety and protection on U.S. soil. In some cases, the motion is to send a person to Uganda to present and defend their asylum case there.



Pagina #3 (3)

lo que ha llevado a muchos de manera forsada a Pedir Salida Voluntaria Como Unica opcion Para regresar a sus Paises de origen a Expensas del peligro al que podamos estar Expuestos

en dichas Cortes los Jueces manifiestan al detenido que Puede Comprar el Tiquete de Avion Para el regreso a su Pais, Pero los oficiales de ICE Niegan esa posibilidad infamandonos que no se compren esos tiquetes

Asi, mismo se presenta una Contrariedad en los procesos con Salidas Voluntarias y deportaciones aprobadas ya que Tienen 2, 3 o más meses esperando ser enviados a su pais de origen.

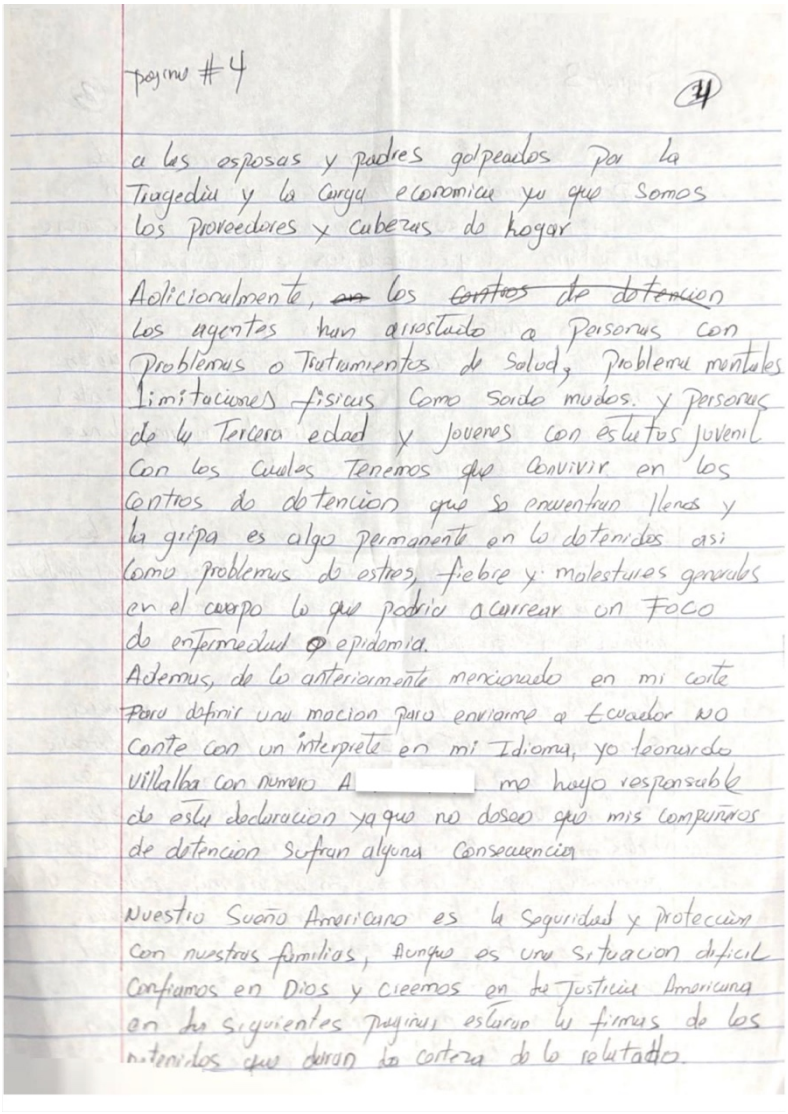
Nos Sentimos Vulnerados y de Cierta manera Secuestrados o retenidos sin justificacion, Vemos con Profunda Impotencia y Frustracion que se nos ha Violado el debido proceso, debida defensa y desconocido Beneficios otorgados en la 4,5 y 6 enmienda de la Constitucion americana, adicional a ello se destruyen familias separandolas donde hay hijos y Sobrinos menores de edad que estan Sufriendo un impacto Psicologico muy fuerte porque no Comprenden la situacion y en algunos Casos han presenciado los arrestos

This has forced many to request voluntary departure as the only option to return to their countries of origin, despite the danger we may face, if we are exposed.

In these courts, the judges inform the detainees that they can buy plane tickets to return to their country, but ICE officers refuse this possibility, telling us not to buy those tickets.

Furthermore, there is a contradiction in the processes for voluntary departures and approved deportations, as it takes two, three, or more months of waiting to be sent back to our country of origin.

We feel vulnerable, in a way, kidnapped or detained without justification. We see with profound helplessness and frustration that the right to due process & legal counsel were violated, and benefits granted in the 4th, 5th, and 6th Amendments of the U.S. Constitution were unacknowledged. In addition, families are being destroyed and separated, especially where there are minor children and nephews who are suffering a very strong psychological impact because they do not understand the situation, and in some cases, they were subjected to witnessed the arrests



pagina #4

4

a las esposas y padres golpeados por la Tragedia y la Carga economica ya que Somos los proveedores y cabezas de hogar

Adicionalmente, ~~en~~ los ~~centros de detencion~~ Los agentes han arrestado a Personas con Problemas o Tratamientos de Salud, Problemas mentales Limitaciones fisicas Como Sordo mudos. y Personas de la Tercera edad y Jovenes con estatus juvenil Con los Cuales Tenemos que Convivir en los Centros de detencion que se encuentran llenos y la gripa es algo permanente en los detenidos asi Como problemas de estres, fiebre y molestias generales en el cuerpo lo que podria acarrear un Foco de enfermedad o epidemia.

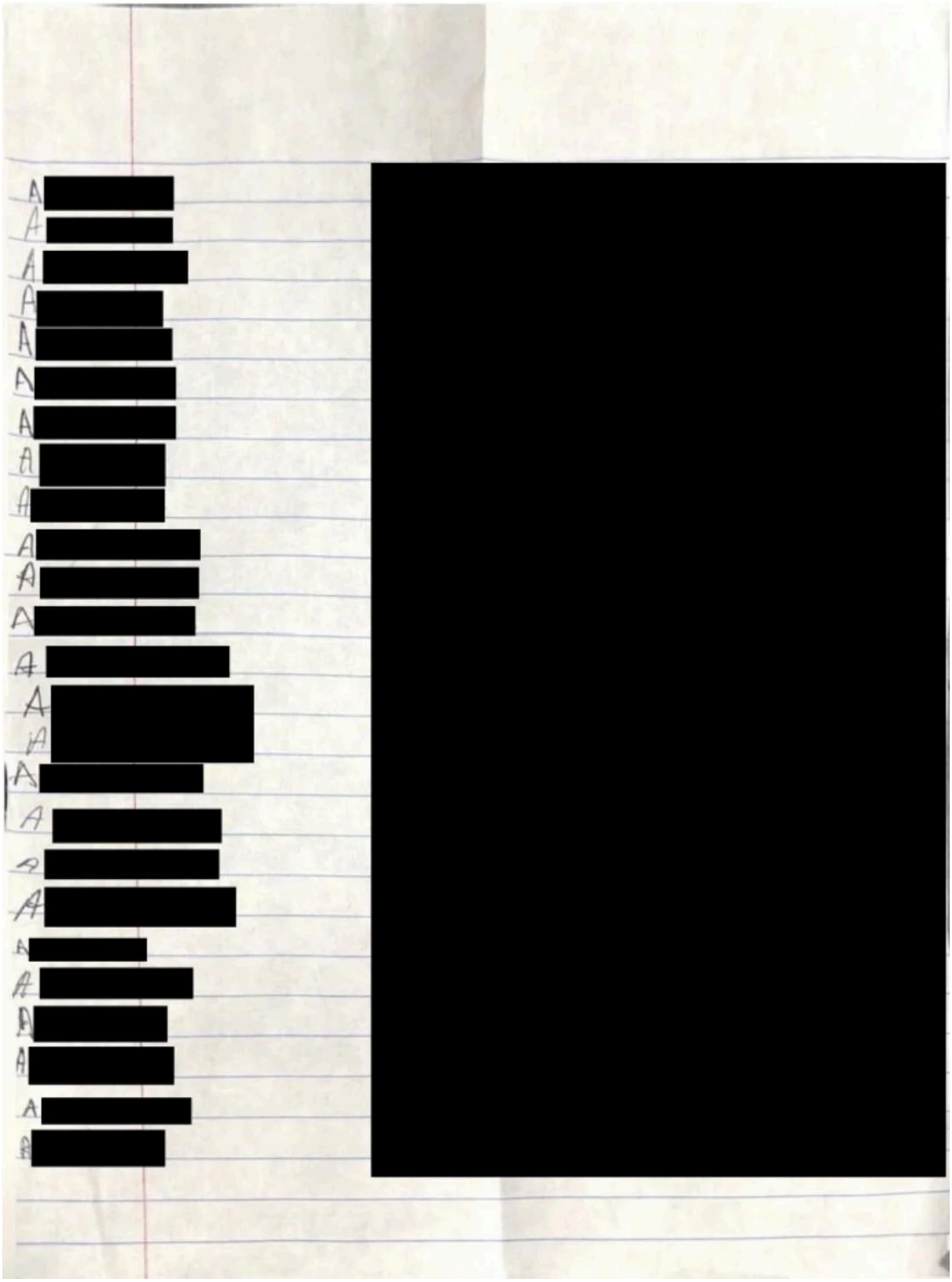
Ademas, de lo anteriormente mencionado en mi corte Para definir una mocion para enviarme a Ecuador NO Conte con un interprete en mi Idioma, yo leonardo Villalba con numero A _____ me hago responsable de esta declaracion ya que no deseo que mis compañeros de detencion Sufran alguna Consecuencia

Nuestro Sueño Americano es la Seguridad y protecion Con nuestras familias, Aunque es una Situacion dificil Confiamos en Dios y Creemos en la Justicia Americana en las siguientes paginas estaran las firmas de los detenidos que daran la certeza de lo relatado.

of their wives and fathers, who are devastated by the tragedy and the economic burden, since we are the providers and heads of our households.

Additionally, the ICE agents have arrested people with mental health issues, physical disabilities such as deaf and non-verbal, elderly individuals, and young people with juvenile status, with whom we have to live in the detention centers that are overcrowded. The flu is a constant problem among the detainees, as are stress, fever, and general body aches; which could lead to an outbreak of illness or an epidemic.

In addition to what was previously mentioned in my court hearing with the motion to send me to Ecuador, I did not have an interpreter in my language. I, Leonardo Villalba, with identification number A■■■■■■■■■, take responsibility for this statement, as I do not want my fellow detainees to suffer any consequences. Our American dream is safety and protection - with our families. Although this is a difficult situation, we trust in God and believe in American justice. On the following pages are the signatures of the detainees who will corroborate what has been stated.



Surreal Descent Continued: Surrealer De-center

In February, the Guardian reported from an undisclosed leak source that ICE had "more than tripled the amount of data it stored in Microsoft's Azure cloud platform in the six months leading up to January 2026, a period in which the agency's budget swelled and its workforce rapidly expanded, according to the files." By this time, Microsoft had famously been providing cloud support for the Israeli Defense Force for several years through the genocide, and had already experienced some public backlash for this financial support of the Apartheid in Gaza.

More than a focused hatred for these bad actors called "Microsoft" or "DHS", my love and respect for my colleagues and myself beleaguered me most. The abject feeling of powerlessness to witness the ways we made sense of ourselves and our work crept into everything. It is actually a painful question: How do normal people end up in jobs building infrastructure for mass-surveillance technologies for a hostile state? And not just normal people, but many tech workers are themselves immigrants and migrants.

Omniscient and malignant surveillance culture is perhaps taken for granted by those outside the tech sector who have become accustomed to the reality of Ring cameras and police surveillance towers and even good old-fashioned police foot patrols, but the ability to take a photo of someone's face -- as ICE officers do using the Mobile Fortify app -- to identify their name and immigration status, which is then linked with their address of residence, phone records, family relationships, and biometric data all in the present moment of the interaction is actually very exceptional. This capability requires an incredible technological infrastructure of immense scale and complexity, which only humankind could be capable of building. No other animal could achieve this.

There are only a few companies in the world which can provide datacenters capable of hosting that much data and relating or processing it at such scale and speed. Datacenter resources *at this scale* are sold in a very narrow market. If a few companies neglected to take these lucrative hosting contracts with ICE and DHS, other private companies would undoubtedly take the bids, but they would cost themselves years and hundreds of millions of dollars to provide access to comparable resources and services on par with the top three cloud providers: Microsoft, Amazon and Google. A denial of service by just three companies would not stop the mass deportations, but it would definitively *delay the administration's efforts by years and/or hundreds of millions of dollars*. Perhaps in that time, human rights lawyers could have recouped more resources to support displaced migrants. Perhaps in that time, international courts could have grown a set of balls which they might use to bring the administration to justice for any number of its recent global atrocities. We know this delay would equal lives saved. We all know this.

The refusal of cooperation by just these three private companies could set back the rise of American fascism and degradation of global civil liberties to a strangely significant degree. This is deeply concerning for two reasons: firstly that an actor, and a centralized, non-human actor, a corporation, of all things, is capable of threatening our practiced concept of civil liberties is a sign of wicked sickness. Microsoft has no investment in human well-being and only seeks to live and grow, like a cancer, at all costs even to its own host. It should never have had access to Weil's force in the first place. The second reason for concern, is that all three actors, given the choice, have of course, done nothing about it.

On February 27th, I was still working at Microsoft. I turned 25 and the United States and Israel began airstrikes in Iran. Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and several members of his family were killed. In Tehran, missile strikes were reported to have occurred on University Street, in the Jomhouri area, and in the northern Seyed Khandan area. On February 28th, The Shajareh Tayyebeh girls' elementary school in Minab, Iran, was struck by a missile. Iranian media reported 180 killed.

On March 19th, The United Nations stated in a humanitarian situation report that families across the Occupied Palestinian Territory observed the month of Ramadan. It continues:

> "The UN Human Rights Office had raised alarm over a pattern of unlawful killings following incidents on 15 March in which two Palestinian families were reportedly killed by Israeli fire in Gaza and the West Bank. The office warned that these incidents, alongside escalating settler attacks and intimidation against Palestinian communities, raise serious concerns about impunity and protection risks for civilians. In the Gaza Strip, most people remain displaced, often living in dire conditions with limited protection and inadequate access to diverse and sufficient supplies, while continuing to face daily shooting and strikes hitting residential areas."
>
> "In the West Bank, displacement linked to settler attacks and access restrictions up to March, 2026 has already reached about 95% of the total numbers recorded in the whole of 2025."

The report continued to note that since the announcement of the ceasefire and the brokerage of the Peace Deal by the Peace Board (a multinational initiative chaired by Trump) in October 2025, 673 Palestinians had been killed.

A hopeful far-right authoritarian regime like ours benefits from senseless global conflict in two ways:

1) Fear of outsiders escalates during wartime, so that civilians can be goaded and manipulated into engaging with xenophobia, and
2) the scale of contemporary warfare including the tertiary civilian violence is incomprehensible.

Coexistence with the fact of war and genocide is itself traumatic, and causes reality's seeming rules of order to fracture into irrationality. Why should children die in a war they did not create? Of course, there's no such reason for this, and seeing that reality does not itself abide by humane rules, the civilian populace is negged to angry, confused

psychosis which taken to its extent, manifests as numbness. This high level of daily senselessness causes us to stop being curious about basic contradictions like “Why do I work at Microsoft if I think war profiteering is despicable?” Our distraction is useful to the regime.

The handler (or the subject) of force is our state. The recipient (or the object) of force is overseas. We, the people are painfully trapped between, somehow guilty twofold:

1) We condone the actions of our state, and sit idly, even feeding coal to its maw as it enacts the uncontrolled prerogative violence of Ernst Frankel’s dual state theory of dictatorship.
2) We enjoy the normative state resulting of #1.

We appear to have lost both ways. The pain we condone does not fully belong to us -- it is prescribed to us collectively by the empire, which exists on our tacit approval. And neither does the pleasure of the normative life even belong to us – it is reaped from the back of uncontrolled, arbitrary violence.

I also have to look away. It’s unbearable. After all, distraction allows the time to pass with less pain, and so at times, opting for distraction can be a temporarily humane choice. The pain comes not from the contradiction itself (which is a truth, not a sensation), but from the inability of the mind to reconcile the contradiction. In other words, the painful act is witnessing. The painful domain is our selves.

But the time lost looking away neither dissolves the contradiction, nor can that time ever be recovered. After my flight from New York to Seattle, I couldn’t remember which movies I’d seen on the plane. I know vaguely that I had enjoyed them, but I couldn’t recall anything specific. The airplane movie which fled my mind like a dream as soon as it ended, did not stir me. It made me laugh at times, though about what, I can't remember. It had served its function, merely providing a place to rest my eyes, so that I could sit still for a while, slack-jawed, analgesic, despite my obvious discomfort. When the movies ended, I, the occluded witness could not remember them because they hardly even happened to me.

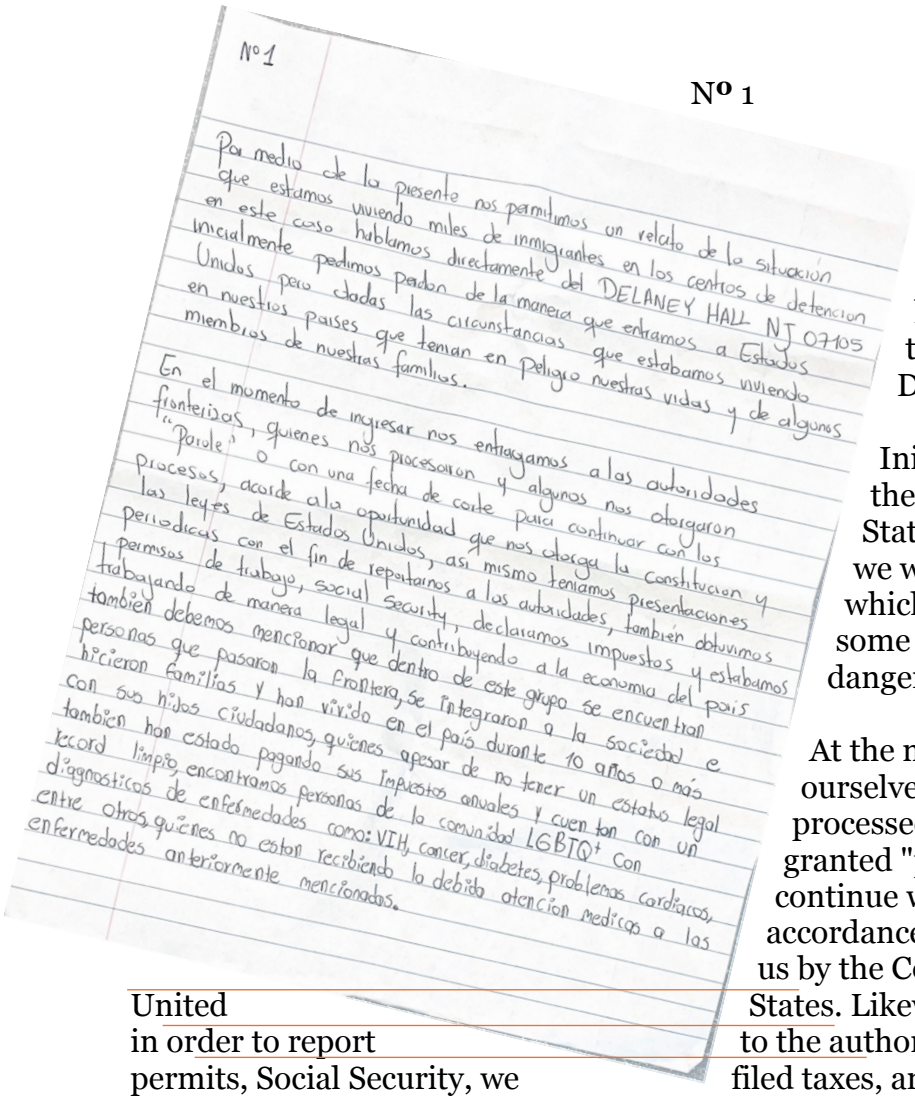
Pain relief is only a sensate benefit if the pain itself was felt first. Real absence precludes real presence. And deliberately looking away from the painful contradictions, while dissociative of pain, is also dissociative of all other aspects of the conscious life. It's hard, but it is important to look it in the eye. Not only to properly justify the ibuprofen (which is necessary at times), but to actually exist as a complex life form. Are you an amoeba? Are you simply a victim and beneficiary of ambient environmental nutrition? Does your pleasure belong to you? Does your pain? The looking, though painful, is essentially liberatory: it allows one to claim the sensations of witnessing for herself. I am not merely a member of a nation, nor a member of a market, nor a member of a life. Even if I feel helpless, I am the domain of perception. I am not the maker of reality, but I am the witness. I decide which pain I feel. It is not prescribed to me. And if or when the world delivers justice against the atrocities of this administration, that triumph will belong to me too.

Why is war profiteering despicable? As a thought exercise, seek a reason beyond the sheer pathos-level disgust of benefitting from another's death, suffering and harm. We know this pathos can become impotent in very complex systems like the modern private tech sector. Feelings-based empathy becomes an inconsistent proof for morality in such systems when individual actors are shielded from the brutality they create.

Purist academic liberal and libertarian proponents of capitalism usually argue in a humanist way that private property and self-driven free markets create the greatest sum of overall human value by facilitating progressive trade and innovation. Perhaps war profiteering is despicable because it exposes this human value. We who are capitalists (by choice or by force) have all tacitly agreed that human suffering is valuable to us. It appears that it is worth our time. It appears that it is worth our time every day.

S.O.S: A Second Letter From Delaney Hall

By 300+ signatories
May 2026, Smuggled out of Delaney Hall ICE Detention Center, New Jersey


Nº 1

Por medio de la presente nos permitimos un relato de la situación que estamos viviendo miles de inmigrantes en los centros de detencion en este caso hablamos directamente del DELANEY HALL NJ 07105 inicialmente pedimos perdon de la manera que entramos a Estados Unidos pero dadas las circunstancias que estabamos viviendo en nuestros paises que temian en peligro nuestras vidas y de algunos miembros de nuestras familias.

En el momento de ingresar nos entregamos a las autoridades fronterizas, quienes nos procesaron y algunos nos otorgaron "Parole" o con una fecha de corte para continuar con los procesos, acorde a la oportunidad que nos otorga la constitucion y las leyes de Estados Unidos, asi mismo teniamos presentaciones periodicas con el fin de reportarnos a las autoridades, tambien obtuvimos permisos de trabajo, social security, declaramos impuestos y estabamos trabajando de manera legal y contribuyendo a la economia del pais tambien debemos mencionar que dentro de este grupo se encuentran personas que pasaron la frontera, se integraron a la sociedad e hicieron familias y han vivido en el país durante 10 años o más con sus hijos ciudadanos, quienes apesar de no tener un estatus legal tambien han estado pagando sus Impuestos anuales y cuentan con un record limpio, encontramos personas de la comunidad LGBTQ+ con diagnosticos de enfermedades como: VIH, cancer, diabetes, problemas cardiacos, entre otros, quienes no estan recibiendo la debida atención medicos a las enfermedades anteriormente mencionadas.

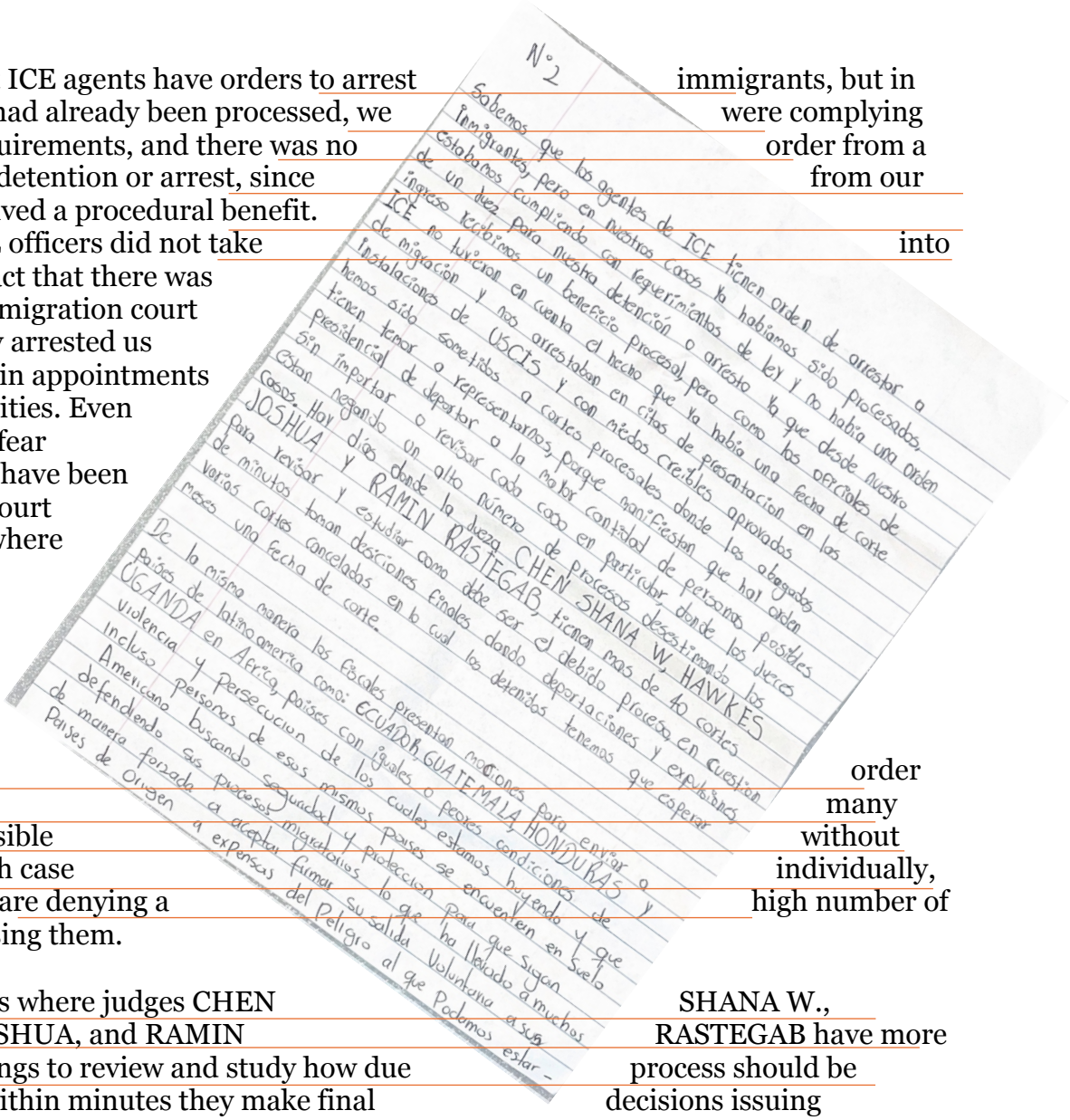
Nº 1

By means of the present, we take the liberty of providing an account of the situation that thousands of immigrants are living in detention centers. In this case, we speak directly of DELANEY HALL NJ 07105.

Initially, we ask for forgiveness for the way we entered the United States, but given the circumstances we were living in our countries, which placed our lives and those of some members of our families in danger.

At the moment of entry, we turned ourselves in to border authorities, who processed us and some of us were granted "parole" or given a court date to continue with our processes, in accordance with the opportunity granted to us by the Constitution and the laws of the United States. Likewise, we had periodic check-ins in order to report to the authorities. We also obtained work permits, Social Security, we filed taxes, and we were working legally and contributing to the country's economy. We must also mention that within this group there are individuals who crossed the border, integrated into society, formed families, and have lived in the country for 10 years or more with their citizen children, who despite not having legal status have also been paying their annual taxes and have a clean record. We find individuals from the LGBTQ+ community with diagnoses of illnesses such as HIV, cancer, diabetes, heart problems, among others, who are not receiving proper medical attention for the aforementioned conditions.

Nº 2

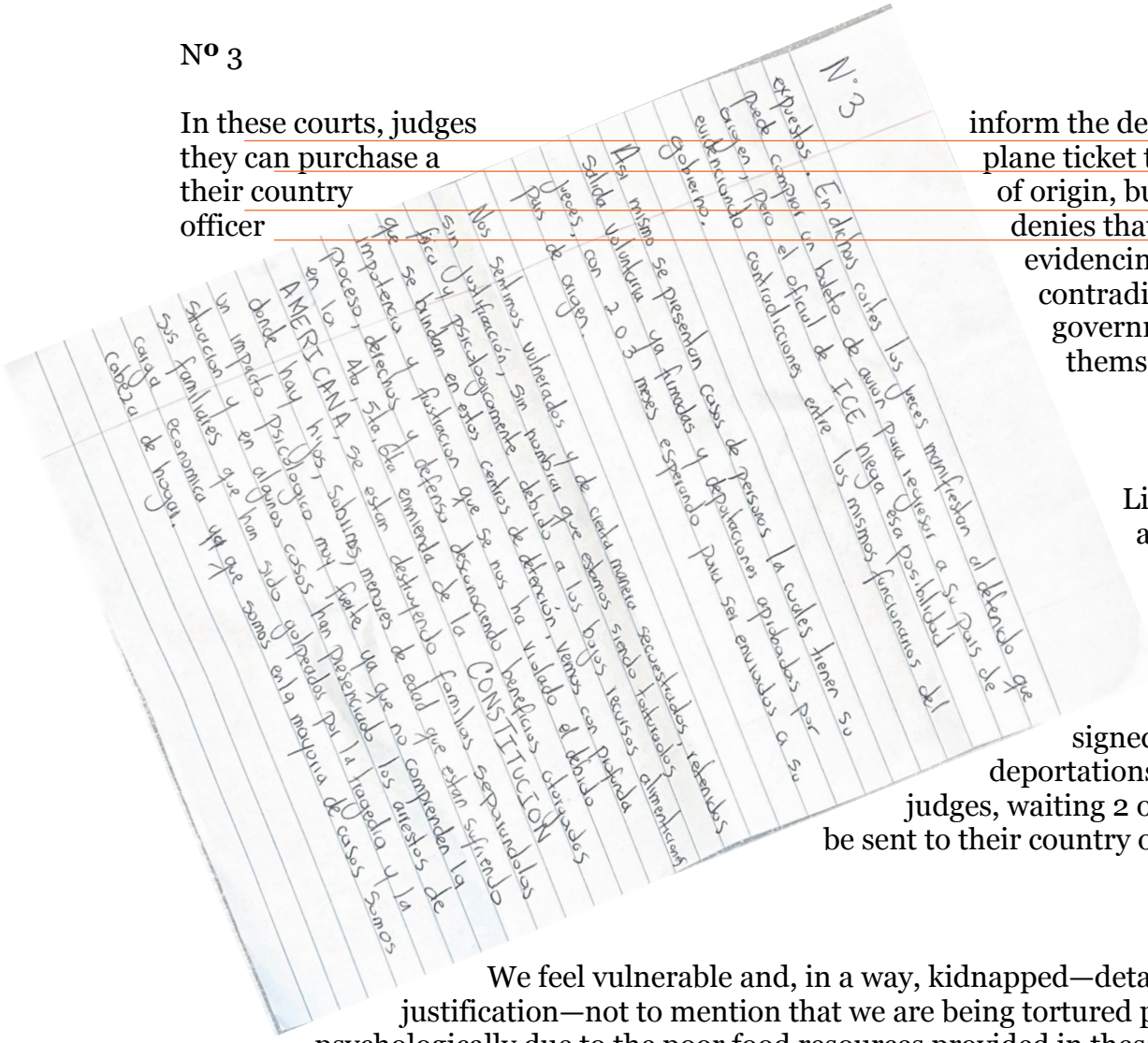


We know that ICE agents have orders to arrest immigrants, but in our cases we had already been processed, we were complying with legal requirements, and there was no order from a judge for our detention or arrest, since from our entry we received a procedural benefit. However, ICE officers did not take into account the fact that there was already an immigration court date, and they arrested us during check-in appointments at USCIS facilities. Even with credible fear approved, we have been subjected to court proceedings where attorneys are afraid to represent us, because they state that there is a presidential order to deport as many people as possible without reviewing each case individually, where judges are denying a high number of cases, dismissing them.

There are days where judges CHEN SHANA W., HAWKES JOSHUA, and RAMIN RASTEGAB have more than 40 hearings to review and study how due process should be applied, yet within minutes they make final decisions issuing deportations and expulsions. Many hearings are canceled, leaving detainees waiting months for a court date.

In the same way, prosecutors file motions to send individuals to Latin American countries such as ECUADOR, GUATEMALA, HONDURAS, and even UGANDA in Africa—countries with equal or worse conditions of violence and persecution from which we are fleeing. Even individuals from those same countries are currently on U.S. soil seeking safety and protection so they may continue defending their immigration cases. This has led many people, under pressure, to accept and sign voluntary departure to their countries of origin at the expense of the danger to which we may be exposed.

Nº 3

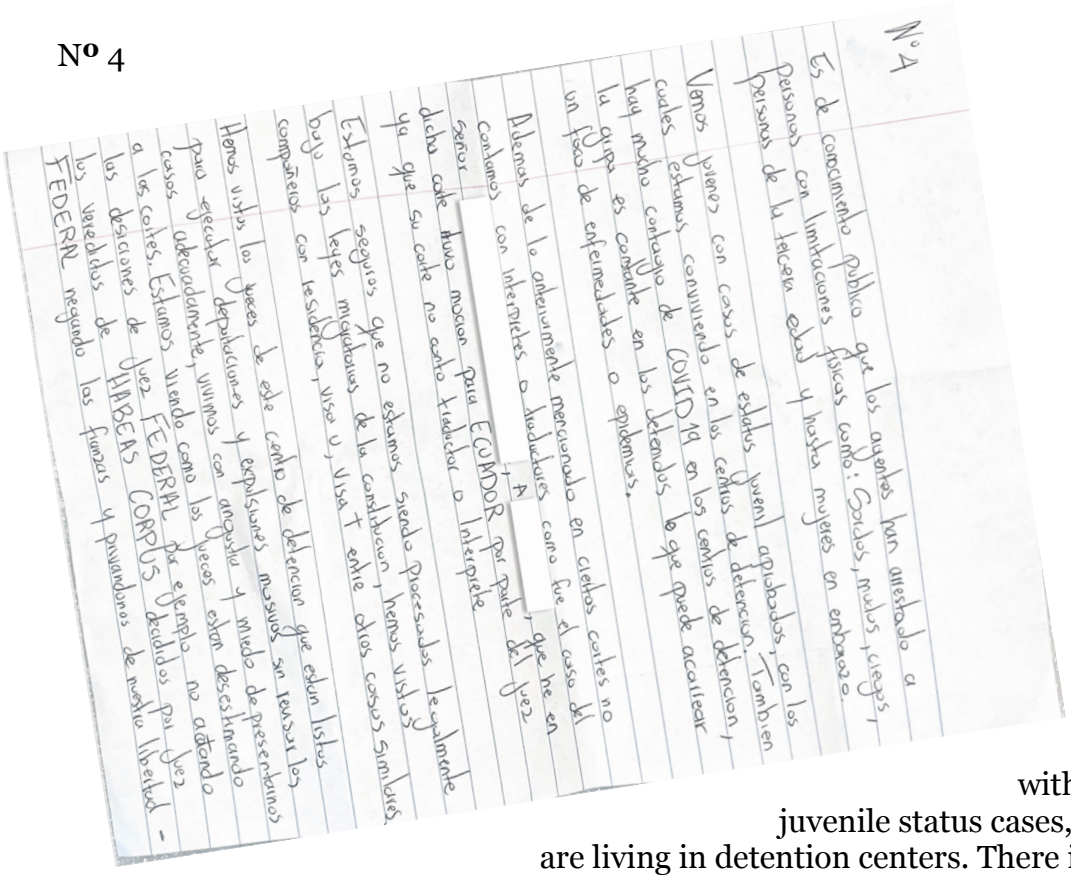


In these courts, judges inform the detainee that they can purchase a plane ticket to return to their country of origin, but the ICE officer denies that possibility, evidencing contradictions among government officials themselves.

Likewise, there are cases of individuals who already have their voluntary departure signed and deportations approved by judges, waiting 2 or 3 months to be sent to their country of origin.

We feel vulnerable and, in a way, kidnapped—detained without justification—not to mention that we are being tortured physically and psychologically due to the poor food resources provided in these detention centers. We see with deep helplessness and frustration that our due process, rights, and defense have been violated, disregarding benefits granted under the 4th, 5th, and 6th Amendments of the UNITED STATES CONSTITUTION. Families are being destroyed and separated, where there are children, nieces, and minors who are suffering a very strong psychological impact because they do not understand the situation, and in some cases they have witnessed the arrests of their relatives, who have been struck by tragedy and the economic burden, since in most cases we are heads of household.

Nº 4



It is public knowledge that agents have arrested individuals with physical limitations such as: deaf, mute, blind individuals, elderly persons, and even pregnant women.

We see young people with approved juvenile status cases, with whom we are living in detention centers. There is also a high spread of COVID-19 in detention centers, and the flu is constant among detainees, which could lead to outbreaks of illnesses or epidemics.

In addition to the above, in certain courts we do not have interpreters or translators, as was the case of Mr ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■, A■■■■■■■■■, who in his court had a motion for ECUADOR by the judge, since the court did not have a translator or interpreter.

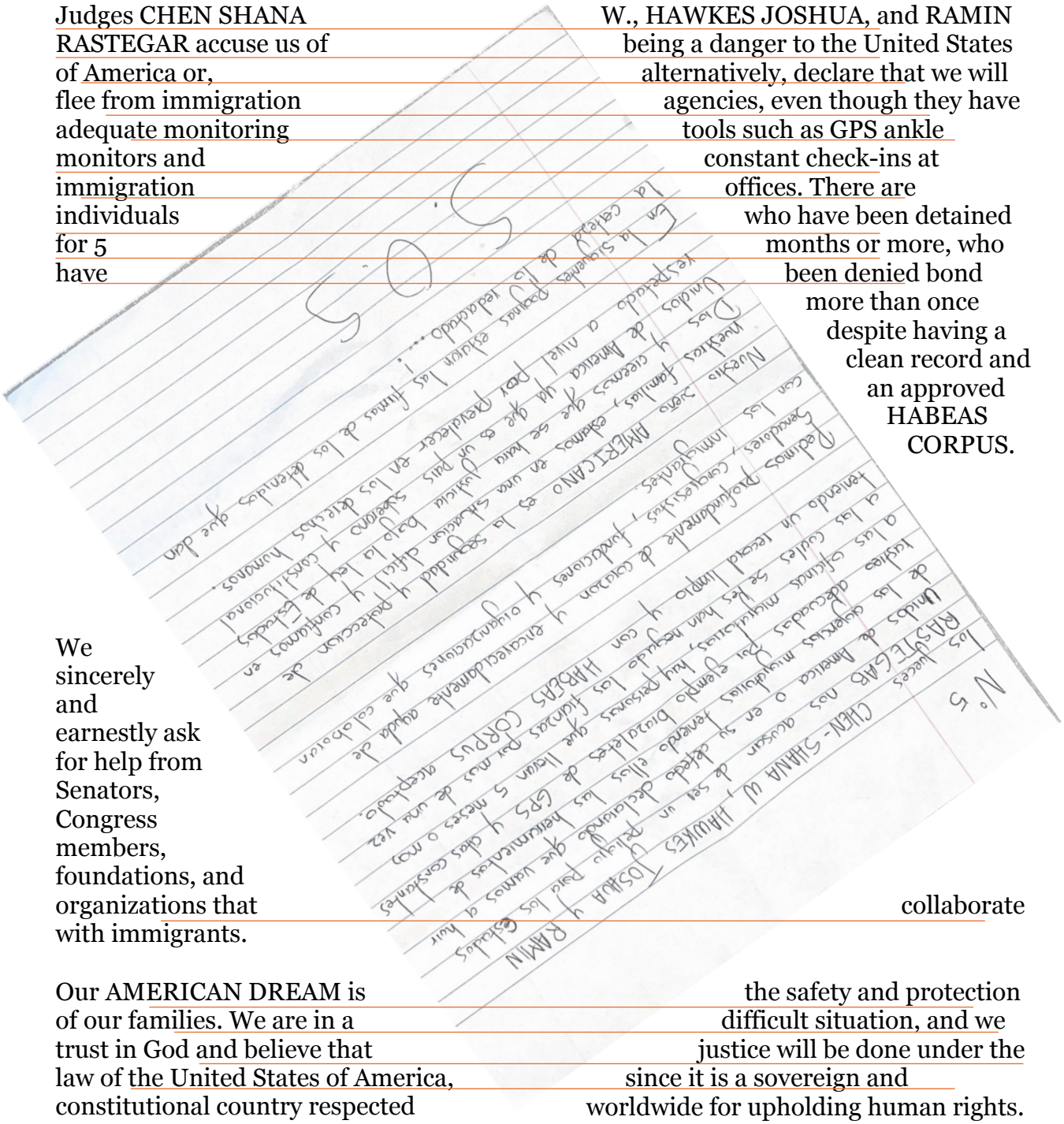
We are certain that we are not being processed equally under immigration laws and the Constitution. We have seen fellow detainees with residency, U visas, T visas, among other similar cases.

We have seen judges in this detention center who are ready to carry out deportations and mass expulsions without properly reviewing cases. We live with anguish and fear of appearing in court.

We are witnessing how judges are disregarding decisions of federal judges, for example not honoring HABEAS CORPUS rulings decided by a FEDERAL judge, depriving us of our liberty.

No. 5

Judges CHEN SHANA W., HAWKES JOSHUA, and RAMIN RASTEGAR accuse us of being a danger to the United States of America or, alternatively, declare that we will flee from immigration agencies, even though they have adequate monitoring tools such as GPS ankle monitors and constant check-ins at immigration offices. There are individuals who have been detained for 5 months or more, who have been denied bond more than once despite having a clean record and an approved HABEAS CORPUS.

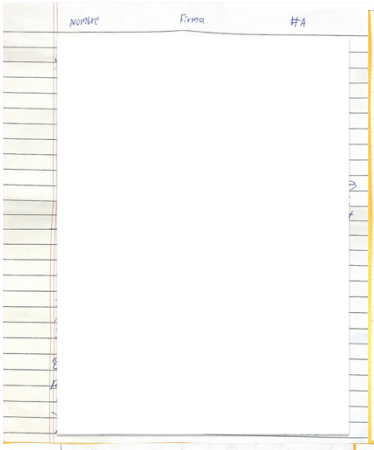


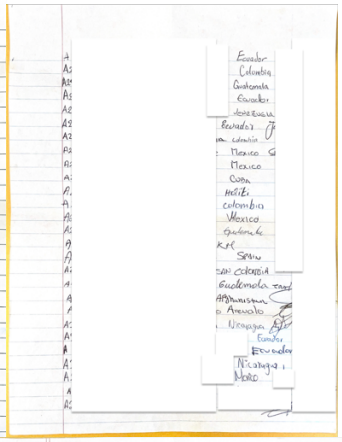
We sincerely and earnestly ask for help from Senators, Congress members, foundations, and organizations that collaborate with immigrants.

Our AMERICAN DREAM is the safety and protection of our families. We are in a difficult situation, and we trust in God and believe that justice will be done under the law of the United States of America, since it is a sovereign and constitutional country respected worldwide for upholding human rights.

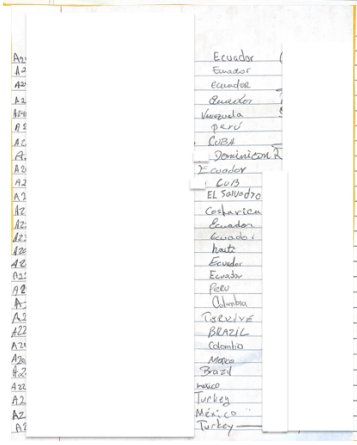
On the following pages are the signatures of the detainees who certify what is written.

S.O.S

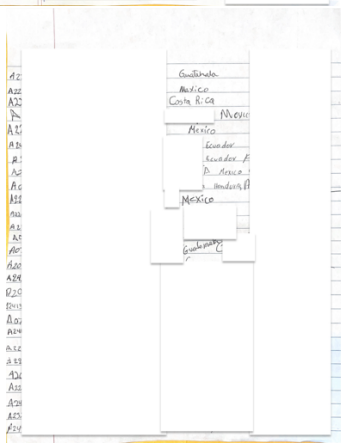

Nombre
Firma
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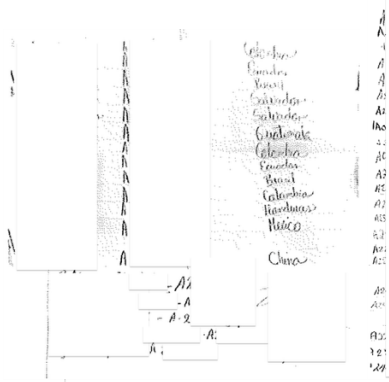

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Dominican R.
Ecuador
El Salvador
Costa Rica
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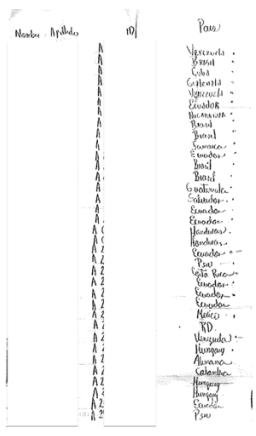

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Guadeloupe


Colombia
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Nombre
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Pais
Venezuela
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Cuba
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Prarieland

In March, the Prairieland trials had begun to develop a baldly punishing and authoritarian tone. Daniel Sanchez Estrada had been sentenced 30 years of prison time for moving a box full of anarchist zines after the anti-ICE protest on July 4th, 2025 at the Prairieland ICE Detention Center in Alvarado, Texas. Estrada wasn't present at the July 4 demonstration; they were at home. Their technical convictions were "corruptly concealing a document or record" and "conspiracy to conceal documents."

Here is what happened on July 4: Eleven activists held a noise demonstration at the Prairieland ICE Detention Center in Alvarado, Texas to set off fireworks in solidarity with the detainees inside the facility. The noise demonstration started peacefully but escalated, with reports of vandalism, spray-painting graffiti, and slashing tires in the parking lot. Armed officers arrived at the scene, and while there are conflicting accounts on what officially transpired, it was established that one officer drew his gun on the protestors in the parking lot, after which one of the activists, Benjamin Song, fired their weapon, resulting in that officer being shot and sent to the hospital. The officer survived and was released the following morning.

Since domestic terrorism has no concrete legal definition in America, offenders are usually charged instead with well-defined legal tangents like hate crimes, possession or unlawful discharge of firearms, treason and seditious conspiracy, and providing material support to terrorists. But in late 2025, Trump had issued an executive order to define "Antifa" as a Domestic Terrorist Organization (DTO). NPR for North Texas reports that the designation is the first of its kind in history, not used even for notorious, longstanding groups like the Ku Klux Klan.

The Associated Press writes "Antifa" is simply short for anti-fascist: "It is not a single organization but by definition a decentralized movement of far-left militant groups who are against fascism, and may confront or resist neo-Nazis and white supremacists at demonstrations." The designation of anti-fascists as a DTO ultimately allowed the Prairieland trials a year later to be legally biased toward the suppression of free speech and harsher punitive sentencing since the anti-fascist activism was then associated with terrorism. In their trial, the Prairieland defendants denied association with a "leftist antifa terror cell", explaining that most of them did not know each other prior to the demonstration at all and had met for the first time onsite. Benjamin Song defended anti-fascism as a general belief, saying: "What kind of people are not against fascism?"

For reference, the punishment for each one of the Prairieland protesters exceeds the lengthiest prison sentences given out for the attack on the Capitol on January 6 of 2021. Enrique Tarrio, the leader of the Proud Boys who was convicted of seditious conspiracy, was sentenced to just 22 years in prison. Stewart Rhodes, the leader of the far-right group the Oath Keepers, was sentenced to 18 years in prison (just over half the sentence

for moving a box of anarchist zines). The FBI estimates 2,000–2,500 people entered the Capitol during the attack. Rioters vandalized, looted, and assaulted Capitol Police officers and journalists. Capitol Police evacuated and locked down both chambers of Congress and several buildings in the Complex. Rioters occupied the empty Senate chamber, while federal law enforcement officers defended the evacuated House floor. Pipe bombs were found at the Democratic National Committee and Republican National Committee headquarters, and Molotov cocktails were discovered in a vehicle near the Capitol.

On January 20, 2025, during the first day of his second term, Trump granted blanket clemency. Multiple January 6 defendants have since been involved in additional crimes after being pardoned including homicide, burglary, theft, stalking, child pornography, sexual assault on minors, and driving under the influence. By June 2026, at least 97 defendants had been re-arrested and charged with other crimes.

Pedantic and inconsistent interpretation of sedition law and resulting criminalization of activism are common behavioral responses of an unstable authority struggling to maintain power over its republic. For example, in the summer of 2020 in response to BLM, the Department of Justice issued a memo to prosecutors encouraging them to explore federal seditious conspiracy charges for activists and protestors. In the memo, Deputy Attorney General Jeffrey Rosen writes that a federal seditious conspiracy charge "does not require proof of a plot to overthrow the U.S. Government, despite what the name might suggest."

But in the case of the Capitol Riot, there was superficial collateral damage for the cult of Trump: Nine Oath Keepers were originally found guilty of seditious conspiracy to stop the presidential transition of Joe Biden. Clearly, the executive blanket clemency of all 1,300 convicted rioters is deeply hypocritical, considering the overly harsh sentences given to the Prairieland defendants, but the way that Trumpian cult-hypocrisy implements itself as systemic violence is in the legal justification and enablement for his whim. By this dimension, the state interaction with both Jan 6th rioters and Prairieland defendants is shockingly consistent.

The goal of the rioters in both cases is to deny the authority of a state institution. The goal of the state in both cases is to create power by rousing fear and flaunting its own consequential ability to legitimize and codify into law, arbitrary violence for the sake of "the safety of the republic". The state then remolds the language of legality around itself to quell dissidents, *both by pardon and incarceration*, and to control the narrative of dissidents as either terrorists or heroes. Our perception shifts ever so slightly. We are no longer in control of our own reality.

But why bother with legality at all, when a racist agenda can clearly be executed extra-legally? "Legality" is the system of logic by which power establishes its existence. Legality is an ontological language which shapes our perception of human social organization, and our shared reality in all its parts. The pardons therefore impose a very dark message, even to the convicted January 6th rioters themselves. The same message

is delivered when “Antifa” activism can be legally convicted as terrorism in a court of law: Reality itself bends the knee to power.

This is a classic play in the authoritarian playbook: State leaders ensure their own will to power by encouraging a punitive culture of obsession with national security, and an existential sense of the nation under attack. Regarding the psychological motivation for ordinary people to support or condone fascism and genocide, the Cohen Institute for Holocaust and Genocide Studies explains succinctly: “Trauma allows for the embrace of the irrational. Escapism fosters a minimum of self-respect and the ability to vent judgement against a world in which people cannot exist with dignity. Traditional lifestyles are uprooted or threatened by technological changes, wealth inequity, and unequal access to goods and services. Contempt for truth and reason reflects the despair of the follower who is socially and spiritually adrift and cynical. Providing a coherent explanatory narrative and political rallies reinforces a sense of belonging. That things “just happen” is unacceptable to the follower who, in turn, must believe the infallibility of the leader to reclaim their own pride and sense of worth.”

By pure fact of turnout, by commitment, intensity and length of the destructive conspiracy and by literal damage to property and body, the Capitol Attack was vastly more criminal than Prairieland, but the definition of “criminality” itself has already retracted its anchor to reality. The administration and the DOJ’s message is clear and unified in both the cases of Prairieland and Jan 6th: You are in immediate danger. Your world is coming to hands and guns. Desperate people are on the loose and you are also one of them. I will protect you when I can control you.

This is a bipartisan threat. It is of course, a very attractive narrative, given that this narrative promises safety, and only requires the individual to relinquish her own responsibility to the future, and abdicate her will. I began to understand my old coworkers. They weren’t just afraid or intentionally blind or materially bound. They were also suicidal. They accepted death.

They couldn’t physically leave Earth for various reasons, but there are plenty of ways to die while continuing to live and breath: Their affection for intellectual rigor and curiosity had been bent toward ends of violence, cruelty, and oppression. They no longer act in motions according to their own humane values, and their daily lives had departed (if not in process, then in result) from the defense of human goodness. Comforts such as well-stocked grocery stores and relaxing daily schedules resulted in individual depoliticization and then the motions of one’s will and soul are jellyfish in the water – subordinated by whatever ambient current can apply the most force, be it a market or a state.

I used to think that we all simply underestimated the soft trauma of daily life in our so-called capitalist democracy. That we didn’t fully *comprehend* that buying chicken at the grocery store is made possible by several layers of intraspecies and interspecies violence, subjugation, and exploitation. If we knew this, how could we endure the pain of condoning it? How could we drive cars? Fly on planes? Go to work and in a phrase, live

our lives? But I think we don't give ourselves enough credit. We know exactly what we are doing.

In the modern life, the deterioration of the respect one has for herself is begged all the time. For a wealthy modern American (and by that I mean one that is housed and fed), it is no longer possible to live a life strictly according to moral values. Very few of us actually shoot the United Healthcare CEO. But any desire for escape or transcendence which might manifest in action is violently tempered by numbing agents like escapist fantasies, past-nostalgia, material comfort, paralytic shame, and if none of these get you, it is the sheer desperation of the present. Very rarely can any of these be bypassed toward real political action. We retreat instead to suicidality of the spirit: the inability to imagine a dignified future, one in which our values are enacted by our lives.

Through my harm reduction group, I came to understand that anyone who wants to die, if awarded the true dignity of the private experience of their own pain, deserves to die. Life has become unbearable for them, and escape is a most rational choice, natural even. Perhaps it's simply easier than surviving. Perhaps the possibility of a better future is unrealistic. Perhaps death would only require laying down. Nonexistence itself is endlessly defensible for the individual suffering. The insistence of such miserable ordinary people such as us to identify with the capitalist imperialist systems causing our own material misery is not proof of the individual's ability to depart fully from rational thinking. It is a rational choice. It is logical pain relief, escapism -- a very slow, and socially acceptable form of suicide.

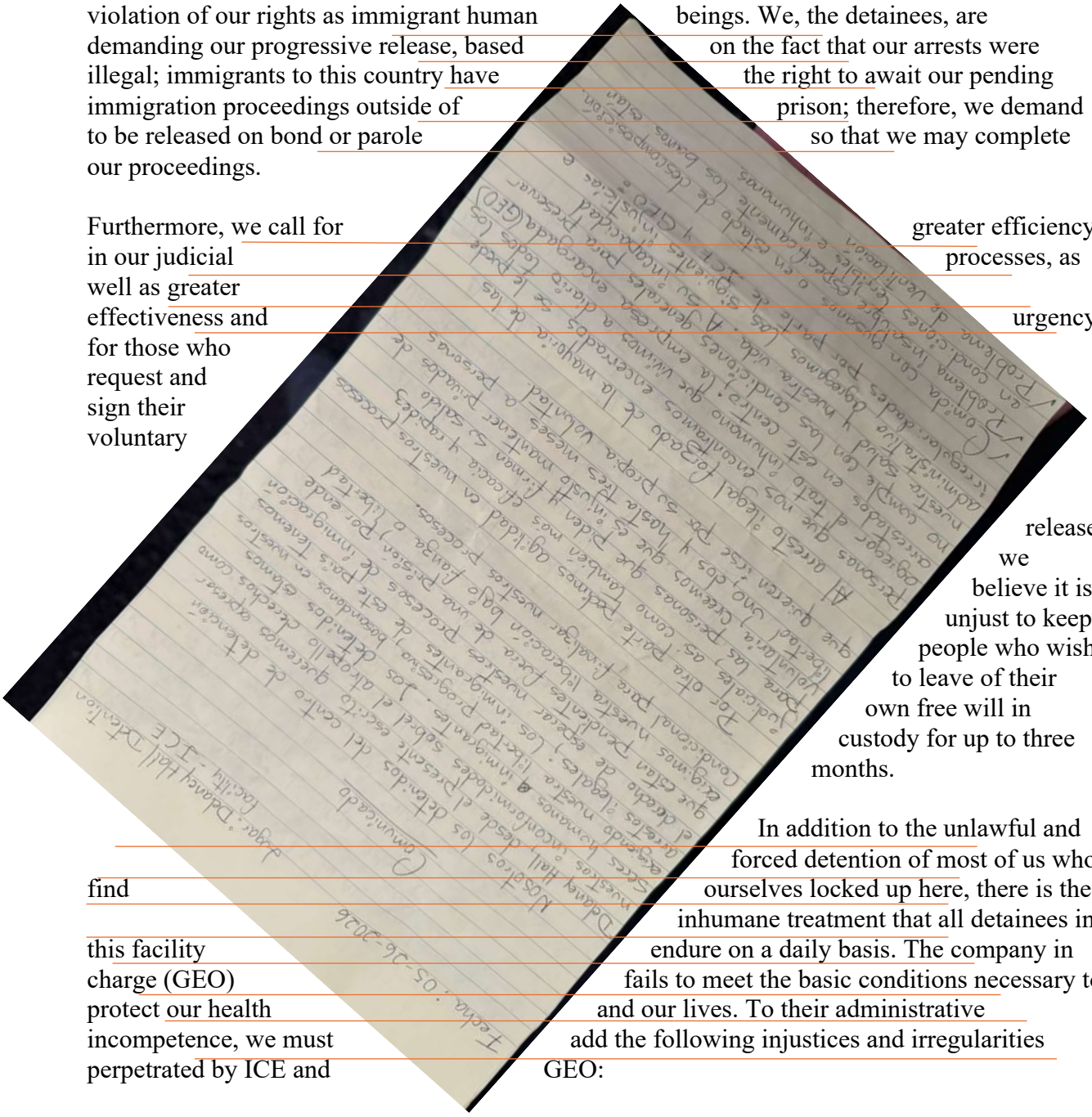
When I quit my job in April, I had moved on from my confusion about the self-destructive nature of bystanders in the tide of empire. All people engage in acts of limited self-harm all the time. I could not understand anything, and I understood too much. I then came to fully identify with their desperation, worthlessness and desire to die.

Communique: A Third Letter From Delaney Hall

May 2026

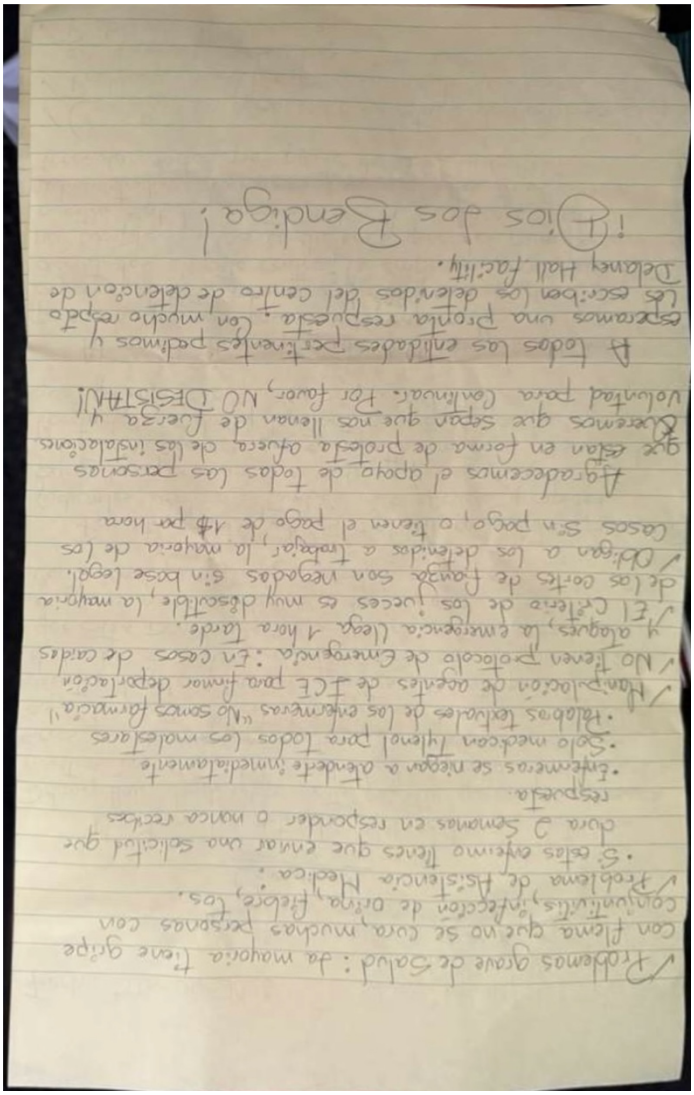
We, the detainees at the Delaney Hall Detention Facility, wish to express our objection to the violation of our rights as immigrant human beings. We, the detainees, are demanding our progressive release, based on the fact that our arrests were illegal; immigrants to this country have the right to await our pending immigration proceedings outside of prison; therefore, we demand to be released on bond or parole so that we may complete our proceedings.

Furthermore, we call for greater efficiency in our judicial processes, as well as greater effectiveness and urgency for those who request and sign their voluntary release; we believe it is unjust to keep people who wish to leave of their own free will in custody for up to three months.



In addition to the unlawful and forced detention of most of us who find ourselves locked up here, there is the inhumane treatment that all detainees in this facility endure on a daily basis. The company in charge (GEO) fails to meet the basic conditions necessary to protect our health and our lives. To their administrative incompetence, we must add the following injustices and irregularities perpetrated by ICE and GEO:

- Food containing worms or in a state of decay.
- Unresolved issues, particularly regarding the bathrooms, which are in terrible and inhumane condition.
- Ventilation problems.
- Serious health issues: most people have a persistent flu with phlegm that won't go away; many have conjunctivitis, urinary tract infections, fever, and coughs.
- Medical care issues:
    - If you're sick, you have to submit a request that takes two weeks to be answered—or you never get a response at all.
    - Nurses refuse to treat you right away
    - They only prescribe Tylenol for all ailments
    - The nurses' exact words: "We're not a PHARMACY"



- ICE agents coerce detainees into signing deportation orders
- There is no emergency protocol: in cases of falls or attacks, emergency response arrives an hour late
- Judges' rulings are highly questionable; most bond requests are denied without legal basis
- Detainees are forced to work, in most cases without pay, or for $1 an hour

We appreciate the support of everyone who is protesting outside the facility. We want you to know that you give us the strength and determination to keep going. Please, DON'T GIVE UP!

We ask all relevant authorities for an urgent response and look forward to hearing from them. With the utmost respect, the detainees at the Delaney Hall facility.

God bless you!

In May I Did Acid

Growing up in the myth of an all-powerful and all-loving God like the Christian one sets you up for legendary heartbreak. The first time I broke up with my God, I was in high school. I felt immense jealousy toward the people who still believed that the universe was created by a loving being, and not simply a being who loves, but who loves *me, specifically*. That delusion is the most beautiful thing we have ever made, and I still reach for it all the time.

Personalization of love (like all my other psychological deficiencies) appears to be a learned rationalization from childhood when those who controlled my physical universe by all practical means *did* specifically love me. My mother and my father were my creators. They fabricated my flesh. They decided what I ate and saw, when I slept and woke, and in no uncertain terms, dictated at every moment, whether I would live or die. They were by very definition gods who specifically love me (if only gods of a limited domain).

One alternative theory is self-apotheosis: God exists, and She is Me. Believing I am Jesus, a prophet, or a chosen divine figure is one of the best-documented delusions in schizophrenia. Not because religion causes the illness, but because religious figures are ready-made symbols of ultimate moral authority, historical significance, and a private line to the truth. When the inside of my head feels revelatory and universe-shaping, self-appointed apotheosis is an efficient plot container to respond to the terrifying question: why does everything feel so important? The answer fits the size of the feeling: because I am central to the story.

The very definition of "self" is a similar religious delusion. "I" can kill things. "I" can love them. "I" appear to exist, and "I" appear to be devastatingly important. Aside from self as individual, there are varying perceptions of self including family (clearly we imagine families as being members of our selves, we even share the identifiers of name), twosomes (couples being one of the most popular structures of "selfhood") and larger collective selves like neighborhoods, races and nations. Usually, it is convenient to conform to the naturally emergent conception of self whose most obvious shape is the singular body. My body, after all, is the one through which all of life appears to be sensed. This gets us well enough through life, and importantly, it at least *appears* to make sense.

In Islam, the doctrine of tawhid (Oneness of God) strictly disallows me from associating with the divinity of God. It is unfavorable to claim that I am Allah, or to engage in the self-aggrandizing delusion that I am not only solely responsible for the collective fate of humanity, but actually capable of changing it. Some Sufis get around this mess by the philosophy of Wahadat al-wujud according to which the monotheistic God is identical with existence and this one existence is that through which all existing things exist. This

means, not that I *am* God, but that I am *of* God, if and only if everything else also is of God, to the same exact extent. We are all One in God, which explains how we might love each other (or in other words, love ourselves, as a religious act of collective transcendence).

The popular Christian theory argues that God's will is simply carried out through the materials of earthly things such as plants, the weather, and us. We are not God, but we are the actors of Her Will. It's another bargaining idea which attempts to explain the essential Christian paradox: the apparently limited nature of God's supposedly unlimited power.

But all philosophies of self, not just the monotheistic religious ones, have to, in some way, explain the incredible grief of human helplessness in the face of human suffering. Contending are the two apparent realities that I am a member of the most powerful animal on Earth, and at the same time that I am daily powerless against enormous concerts of human-invented suffering. This basic contradiction makes me feel like my skin has been made suddenly inside out, and like I am raw to every slightest wind and light.

Experts often cite personalization (and personalized theories of persecution) as one of the primary conditions necessary for genocide:

1) Obviously, massive power must aggregate.
2) Human beings must feel fear.
3) They must fear outsiders.
4) But finally, and perhaps most critically, they must personalize that fear. They must imagine that their "in-group" is existentially threatened by the "out-group" and that the "in-group" specifically deserves to exist.

It seems that once the self emerges as a framework of perception, threats to the self naturally justify in turn, threats to the other – things that are not me. Is it actually possible to transcend personalization? Or do we just elect for more and more "useful" i.e. "collective" ideas of selfhood, until all living things are "me" and therefore deserving of dignity?

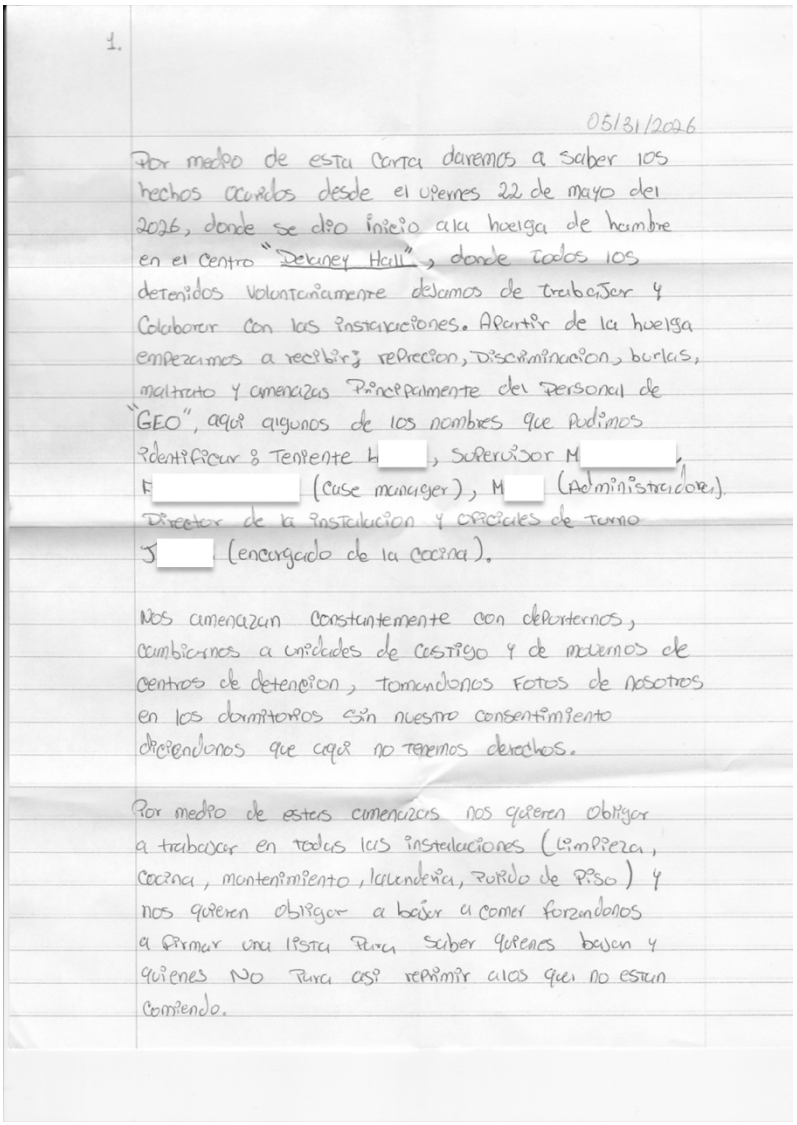
I thought about all these questions again, midday in May, high as balls on the acid tabs. I sat on top of a boulder off the West Manhattan Riverside Parkway with three friends, overlooking 30 or 40 children between five and ten years of age running around in an enclosed playground about the size of a basketball court. Sachi observed that there are certainly bullies down there, and that we were witnessing a complex and self-contained ecosystem of hardship, growth, and of course, play. The playground terrain was generously diverse: fountains, plastic boulders, red slides, blue swings, snacks, gravel, benches, sand, the works. The nannies and moms sat around the peripheries sweating through their shirts.

I said to Daniel, if I was God, all the world would be a playground. The ground would only be hard enough to learn the lesson of the fall, but soft enough to go on. All the bullies would only be slightly taller than us. Difficulties would be didactic and aptly

measured according to our abilities, such that we could surmount them and come out pleasantly emboldened, overcome. Mothers and nannies would always be within a second's reach. There would always be someone nearby to save us. If I was God, the world would be safer and more fun, which is as good a proof as any that I don't appear to be Her.

But I do love people. I am no longer Christian, but still have a relatively devotional and human-centric stance. I love the other as I did once love God, and I feel that if there is anything called God, that love must be some expression of it. It also seems that all human sicknesses exist inside of me. Inside every horrible collective human impulse (slavery, empire, war, genocide), I see myself. I see that all humanity's evil is identified in the composition of my spirit. I hate myself every day. I hate others every day. I am trying whatever I can to lend us all the dignity and love I feel we deserve. But I fail to do this all the time, at every single level. I still don't understand. It's possible that I never will. This essay has no coherent thesis. I'm trying to accept this.

We demand freedom: A Fourth Letter from Delaney Hall



1.

05/31/2026

Por medio de esta carta daremos a saber los hechos ocurridos desde el viernes 22 de mayo del 2026, donde se dio inicio a la huelga de hambre en el centro "Delaney Hall", donde todos los detenidos voluntariamente dejamos de trabajar y Colaborar con las instalaciones. A partir de la huelga empezamos a recibir; represion, Discriminacion, burlas, maltrato y amenazas Principalmente del personal de "GEO", aquí algunos de los nombres que pudimos identificar: Teniente L[redacted], Supervisor M[redacted], F[redacted] (Case manager), M[redacted] (Administradores). Director de la institucion y oficiales de turno J[redacted] (encargado de la cocina).

Nos amenazan constantemente con deportarnos, cambiarnos a unidades de castigo y de movernos de centros de detencion, tomandonos fotos de nosotros en los dormitorios sin nuestro consentimiento diciendonos que aquí no tenemos derechos.

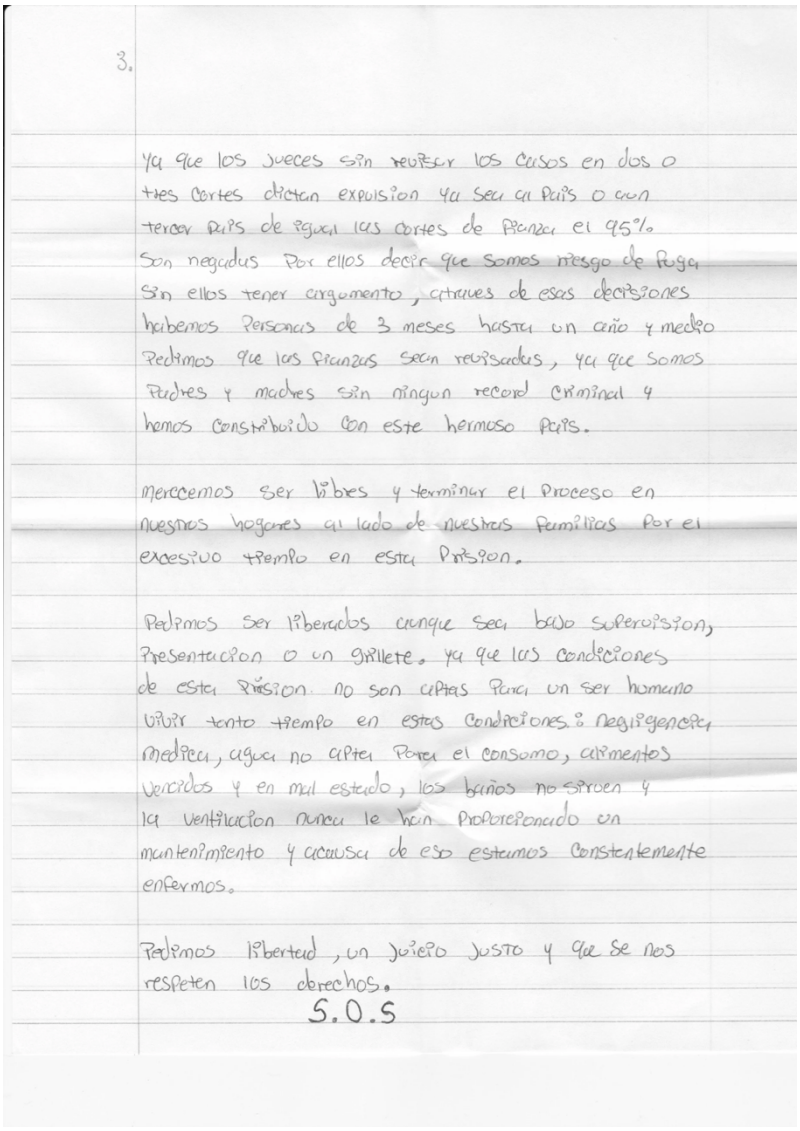
Por medio de estas amenazas nos quieren obligar a trabajar en todas las instalaciones (Limpieza, Cocina, mantenimiento, lavanderia, pulido de Piso) y nos quieren obligar a bajar a comer forzandonos a firmar una lista Para saber quienes bajan y quienes No Para así reprimir a los que no estan comiendo.

5/31/2026

Through this letter, we will provide an account of the events that have taken place since the 22nd of May, 2026, when the hunger strike began at the "Delaney Hall" facility, where people detained have all voluntarily stopped working and assisting with facility operations. Since the strike began, we have been subjected to reprisals, discrimination, mockery, mistreatment, and threats, mainly from "GEO" staff. Here are some names we were able to identify: Lieutenant L■■■■, Supervisor M■■■■■■■■, F■■■■■ M■■■■■■■ (Case Manager), M■■■■■■ (administrator), the facility director and shift officers, J■■■■■ (in charge of the kitchen).

They constantly threaten to deport us, transfer us to punishment units, and move us from one detention center to another; they take photos of us in the dormitories without our consent and tell us that we have no rights here.

Through these threats, they are trying to force us to work in all areas of the facility (cleaning, kitchen, maintenance, laundry, floor polishing) and are trying to force us to go down for meals by making us sign a list so they can track who goes down and who doesn't, in order to punish those who aren't eating.



3.

Ya que los jueces sin revisar los casos en dos o tres cortes dictan expulsion ya sea al país o con tercer país de seguir las cortes de pianza el 95% son negados. Por ellos decir que somos riesgo de fuga sin ellos tener argumento, atraves de esas decisiones hubemos personas de 3 meses hasta un año y medio pedimos que las pianzas sean revisadas, ya que somos padres y madres sin ningun record criminal y hemos constribuido con este hermoso país.

merecemos ser libres y terminar el proceso en nuestros hogares al lado de nuestras familias por el excesivo tiempo en esta prision.

Pedimos ser liberados aunque sea bajo supervision, presentacion o un grillete. ya que las condiciones de esta prision no son aptas para un ser humano vivir tanto tiempo en estas condiciones: negligencia, medica, agua no apta para el consumo, alimentos vencidos y en mal estado, los baños no sirven y la ventilacion nunca le han proporcionado un mantenimiento y acausa de eso estamos constantemente enfermos.

Pedimos libertad, un juicio justo y que se nos respeten los derechos.

S.O.S

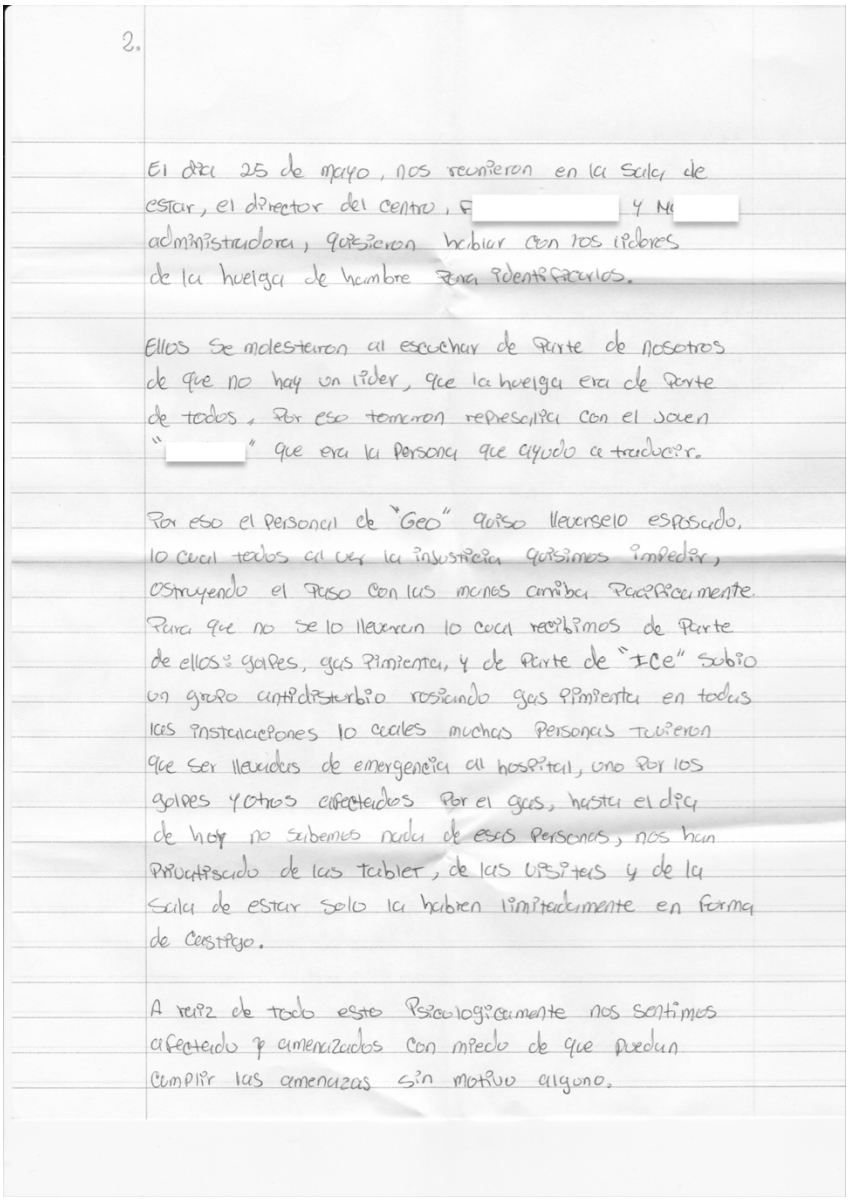
2.

On May 25, we were gathered in the common room; the facility's director, F■■■■■ M■■■■■■■, and the administrator, M■■■■■■, wanted to speak with the leaders of the hunger strike to identify them.

They were upset when we told them there was no leader and that the strike was a collective effort. That's why they took retaliatory action against the young man named "■■■■■■," the person who helped with translation.

That's why the "GEO" staff tried to take him away in handcuffs, which all of us, seeing the injustice, wanted to prevent by peacefully blocking their path with our hands raised so that they wouldn't take him away, in return we received from them: beatings, pepper spray, and from "ICE," a riot squad came up spraying pepper spray throughout the facility, causing many people to be rushed to the hospital - one due to the beatings and others affected by the gas. To this day, we haven't heard anything about those people. They've restricted our access to tablets, visits, and the common room. They only open it on a limited basis as a form of punishment.

As a result of all this, we feel psychologically impacted and are plagued by the fear that they might carry out their threats for no reason at all.



2.

El día 25 de mayo, nos reunieron en la Sala de estar, el director del centro, F [redacted] y M [redacted] administradora, querían hablar con los líderes de la huelga de hambre para identificarlos.

Ellos se molestaron al escuchar de parte de nosotros de que no hay un líder, que la huelga era de parte de todos, por eso tomaron represalias con el joven "[redacted]" que era la persona que ayudo a traducir.

Por eso el personal de "Geo" quiso llevarselo esposado, lo cual todos al ver la injusticia quisimos impedir, obstruyendo el paso con las manos cambio pacíficamente. Para que no se lo llevaran lo cual recibimos de parte de ellos: golpes, gas pimienta, y de parte de "ICE" subio un grupo antidisturbio rosiando gas pimienta en todas las instalaciones lo cuales muchas personas tuvieron que ser llevadas de emergencia al hospital, uno por los golpes y otros afectados por el gas, hasta el día de hoy no sabemos nada de esas personas, nos han privatizado de las tablet, de las visitas y de la sala de estar solo la habren limitadamente en forma de castigo.

A raiz de todo esto Psicologicamente nos sentimos afectado y amenazados con miedo de que puedan cumplir las amenazas sin motivo alguno.

3.

Judges, without checking the cases, order expulsion in two or three hearings, either to the country of origin or to a third country, also 95% of bond hearings are denied claiming that we are at flight risk, even though they don't have actual arguments. Through these rulings there are people who are here from 3 months to a year and a half. We ask for the bonds to be revised since we are fathers and mothers with no criminal record and we have contributed to this beautiful country.

We deserve to be free and to complete the process at home with our families, given the excessive amount of time we have spent in this prison.

We could be released, even if it means being under supervision, required to report regularly, or wearing an ankle monitor. The conditions in this prison are not fit for human beings over such a long period of time: medical neglect, water unfit for consumption, food that is past its expiration date and in poor condition, bathrooms that are unusable, and ventilation systems that have never been maintained and because of this, we are constantly sick.

We demand freedom, a fair trial, and for our rights to be respected.

S.O.S

This page contains the names and A-numbers of twenty-eight people who signed this letter.

This letter was signed by a total of fifty-six people detained at Delaney Hall.

How Do We Save Ourselves?

In June, I re-read the Wretched of the Earth, a political manifesto by the revolutionary Franz Fanon arguing for the need to respond to colonial oppression with revolutionary violence. In it, Fanon explains that the path of Algerian revolutionary independence from French colonial rule requires the participation of the lumpenproletariat and the peasant classes, both because they are the most ready to fight, and because their volatility may be co-opted by the oppressor to fight on his side, and so they need to be educated and mobilized with urgency.

Though Fanon is mainly talking about African liberation -- in whose context the lumpenproletariat is comprised of "landless peasants" who are despised by society, and separate from the working class of the proletariat -- and does not comment fully on the role of the lumpenproletariat in America, it remains that the January 6th insurrectionists found it within themselves to attempt to violently overturn a system of power that seemed intolerable to them.

However, there are many complications: Most of the January 6th rioters aligned with imperialist right-wing and white-supremacist groups such as the Proud Boys and Oath keepers, and research on the 716 convicted felons and misdemeanants from the Capitol Riot shows that most were employed and working class (which would technically categorize them among the proletariat). However further research showed that out of the 716 individuals who were charged in crimes connected to the riot by the end of 2021, 140 were facing serious financial catastrophes such as bankruptcies, judgments/liens, and foreclosures/evictions.

Further, the level of violence enacted on Jan 6th by this sub-group with financial hardship is also significant. Of the 140, 59 of them allegedly engaged in violence (or 42.14%). Though not a proper "lumpenproletariat" in an academic sense, these people are similarly despised by society, and share the essential class characteristic of desperation. I suppose that I pitied them at some point.

But recently, having joined the ranks of the pitiful myself, I stood three inches from my own reflection, looking long enough to recognize misery and hostility in that beady animal eye belonging to my own face. I could fully identify myself inside of them, their anger at the systems of power, their feelings of worthlessness cured momentarily by the addictive rush of being a part of something larger than myself.

Their basic values had also been flagrantly controverted by the ontological language of legality, and the difference between crime and justice shrank trivial. They had been hijacked by the systems of power, so successfully hijacked that they believed to be their possession, this land which we were all inhabiting called North America. White millennia of force (Weil's force) and empires of capital had continually rewarded brutal narratives of conflict, theft and possession with riches, prosperity, and comfort.

They had clearly been taught to succeed by imagining others as less than deserving of the same safety they now believed belonged to them in some nasty and deranged zero sum inheritance. Reality is too painful, and so the perception shifts again, not just to survive, not just to die, but to enact an actual (if abortive) revolution.

Fanon writes: “At the level of the individuals, violence is a cleansing force. It frees the natives from his inferiority complex and from his despair and inaction; it makes him fearless and restores his self-respect.”

The Capitol rioters are not the natives. These rioters are symptomatic of grave societal disease, but my disdain for them is secondary to my interest in their abortive revolt as a manifestation of *revolutionary* escapism. There is a difference between mine and their escapist fantasies: They did not seek just to die, they wanted to be martyred. Their personalized fantasy of persecution allowed them to imagine themselves as the natives. As a result, they acted out in a self-assured crusade fueled, no doubt, by fear of poverty, fear of outsiders, delusions of personal persecution, and could not see the state institution as the source of their powerlessness, instead out-sourcing their near-anarchist rage to Joe Biden as proxy, and not the structures of power represented by him.

By accepting the hypocritical blanket pardon -- by accepting the brutal authority of the state, because for exactly one moment it *superficially* appeared to serve their distracted personal interest in animal tribalism-- the Capitol rioters completely neutered any true revolutionary ideal which their nascent overture might have embodied. They willfully abdicated their own volatile power, directly to Trump, because he jerked them off just right, and thus the lumpenproletariat, castrated itself to complacency.

They thought “Trump should be the president,” not, “abolish the office of the president.” Really, they got pretty close. This flavor of self-betrayal always invokes immense heartbreak in me because Trump doesn’t give a shit about ordinary people. He doesn’t love you, not the way I do.

Life after Death

In June, Tomás died at the age of 24. He had been showing me Richard Wright haikus, teaching me how to think about them, and how to enjoy them. I was just starting to get it.

So many horrible, old, untalented people continued to live, and Tomás, the poet, was dead. I wasn't angry. I couldn't even make enough sense of things to construct the logic for anger. If I continued to live, I would have to watch more people die: in all probability most of my friends and community (who were older than me on average), most or all my coworkers, mentors, and especially my parents. Parents are the primary group who we children, from birth, must prepare to witness die, for there is a universal law that no parent should ever watch their child die.

I wrote to Tomás's family offering my condolences, and his mother called me back, proving that even this law of the universe was unfaithfully defended. Everything was fucked up. I could not see a future free of unbearable pain. My government was legally kidnapping people on the street. They were being held in a penal colony just eleven miles away from the raucous World Cup Finals in New York City. The MetLife stands were themselves insidiously hawked by DHS agents, as Trump had aggressively refused to decrease ICE presence during the festivities. The circus was in town. It had been authorized by the state.

Crowds of people spilled into the streets stopping traffic, just to look through windows and over shoulders at the games unfolding. I was surrounded daily by surreal joy in which I was painfully unable to participate. By then, the fourth plea letter had come out of the facility and the captive people were still on a hunger strike due to inhumane conditions. What kind of torture must one face to refuse food inside prison? It is one of the very last things afforded.

Every person in the world suddenly became naked to me. All I could see on their faces was unbearable pain. Every single living person, past, present and future experiences the worst pain imaginable to themselves. We are all unbearably transformed by it. We are shaped by it in all our parts. As such, cynicism is a very severe and yet rational framework of thought which provides the essential premise to justify true suicidality (spiritual or physical or both). This is the final, and most important enabling condition of fascism.

Fascism is a problem of hopelessness. It is a type of system failure which occurs when self-worth is unstable enough to be co-opted by movements of blind faith, con-promises of protection and acceptance. Fascism's formation requires ultranationalist and xenophobic violence, but those things are beside the point. Xenophobia is simply

embodied as an age-old vehicle for fear of the unknown. They are simply excuses to farm fear to aggregate power. It is a problem of surreal scale and focus which allows brutality to continue unquestioned. We are being traumatized. We are being numbed. We are dying. Part of what's interesting about the Delaney Hall letters is how repetitive they are and much you want to look away. But the nature of the problem does not often change. It is age old. We are bored of it.

I understand now, how ordinary people like myself come to condone fascism. The more interesting question is: How do ordinary people stop fascism? Or in other words, how do ordinary people continually defend and justify human freedom and human beauty and human equality, when the material reality of those ideals has never existed for everyone at once? How do we reason with the existence of human rights, which we claim to *deserve*, and yet (so far) cannot faithfully implement? How do we argue for the equal value of every human soul, knowing of course that their treatment on Earth will be so unequal and for many, wretched beyond belief. How do we transcend cynicism which is a factual account of reality?

We must break from the illusion of rationality and reality. "Everything is fucked up," while always rationally defensible as a worldview, depletes the imagination of the materials required to construct a livable moment that exists after this one. The fact is, the future is looking really bleak, and we can see that reality abides by no humane rules. There is no such thing as human dignity. You cannot touch it. It was not here before we were like the ocean or the sky. It is only a promise we make for each other out of the self-aggrandizing species-level delusion called love.

To deny fascism, one must first agree to the terms of life. Life is pain. Life cannot be without pain. Human liberty and self-determination only allow one the full dignity of their own pain. The goal is not to end all individual instances of hatred, fear, death and pain. The most common misconception about anarchists is that they oppose coercion and hierarchy existing between two individuals. An anarchist's ideal world contains racist people, because any power capable of eradicating racist thoughts should never exist. To end all individual hatred would require a set of laws which could be used to arbitrarily accept or reject any behavior based on the moral code of the singular governing authority. Once this infrastructure for power exists (for example, in the form of a state), such power can never be wielded without warping he who wields it beyond insanity, beyond death. Such aggregated force simply cannot be wielded: Not by the left, not by the right. No such moderation exists in aggregates of humanity.

The establishment and continued survival of such authority would require an enforcing body (such as a police force and judicial system) which is capable of destroying the freedom of the citizen, and even to convince her that such spiritual (or physical) death is acceptable.

As anarchists, the only thing we ask is for our pain to belong to us. We must claim it. Fanon understands this: On a personal level there is an essential continuity between individual transcendence and collective action. Individual self-worth, in the system which denies the beauty and freedom of every person, must be retrieved through

revolutionary action, that is, an act which challenges the rational and real state of a society defined by power. Fanon explains through several case studies during his years as a psychologist the psychic damage endured by ordinary people living bent to power. In such a system the pain endured is not ours because the force used to make objects of people is not wielded precisely by our selves. It has been endowed to us against our own will. Who of us would choose to subjugate the other? The pain we feel from killing each other like this: We cannot possibly claim it. So instead, we must seek the pain we ourselves can claim. The pain which belongs to us, which in turn becomes our own responsibility: the pain of freedom.

Freedom is pain. Human liberty and self-determination are painful contradictions. They are standards we humans invented in a religious fervor which arbitrarily values each human soul ultimately and equally, and insists on unnatural conditions which have never yet existed. Allow yourself to be marked by pain. Violence is a cleansing force. Wield violence against the tired acceptance of the continued horrors of everyday life. It is attractive to stop at erotic day-dreaming: the desire for things to change. But desire for things to be better is used as a temporary, auxiliary channel for the storage of human goodness. We must not stop there. Past the desire, one must achieve, through will, discipline, and violent reclamation of pain, the truly embodied feeling that it is actually possible for the future to be better than the past. Only then, can the revolution begin.

Five Haikus by Richard Wright

1.

I am nobody:
A red sinking autumn sun
Took my name away.

2.

I give permission
For this slow spring rain to soak
The violet beds.

3.

With a twitching nose
A dog reads a telegram
On a wet tree trunk.

4.

Burning autumn leaves,
I yearn to make the bonfire
Bigger and bigger.

5.

A sleepless spring night:
Yearning for what I never had
And for what never was.

Regarding copyright

"Liberty favors emulation, instead of destroying it. In social equality, emulation consists in accomplishing under like conditions; it is its own reward. No one suffers by the victory."

- From Proudhon (What is Property?)

Hannah Lim

Issue 6: On Sedition



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